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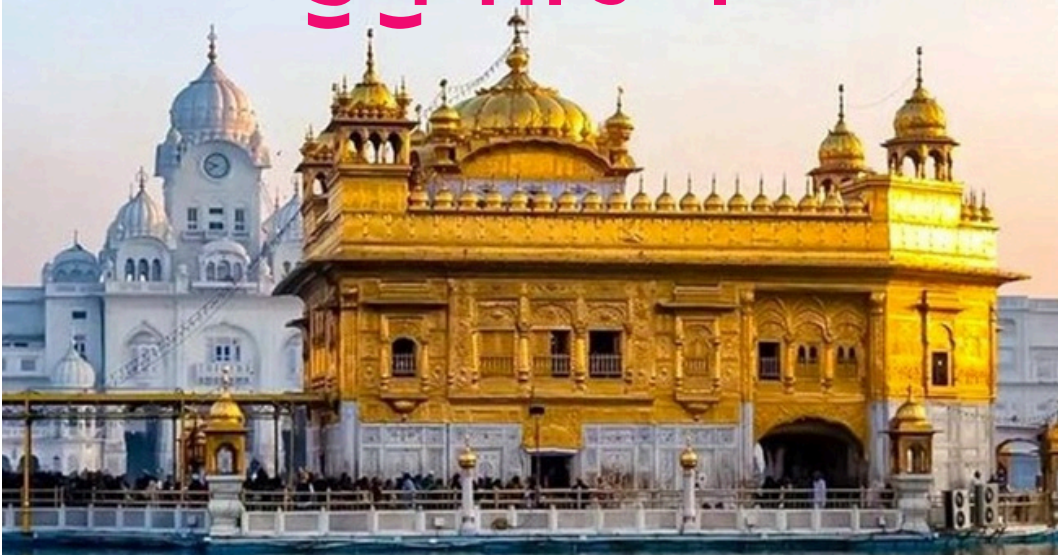

DITHE SABHE THAAV NAHIN TUDH JEHEYA

Author: S. Davinder Singh Thammanwal (Holland)

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2025

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ਲੇਖਕ : ਦਵਿੰਦਰ ਸਿੰਘ ਥੰਮਣਵਾਲ, (ਹਾਲੈਂਡ)

Dithe Sabhe Thaav Nahin Tudh Jeheya

by:
Author : Davinder Singh Thamanwal (Holland)

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ਸਭ ਹੱਕ ਰਾਖਵੇਂ ਹਨ

ਪਹਿਲੀ ਵਾਰ - ਮਈ 2025

ਸਭ
ਹਕ ਰਾਖਵੇਂ ਹਨ

ਕੀਮਤ : ਆਪ ਪੜ੍ਹੋ ਤੇ ਹੋਰਨਾਂ ਨੂੰ ਪੜ੍ਹਾਓ

ਪਤਾ:

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– – **Dedicated** – –

To the grace of Sri Guru Sahib

To the devotion of those who made sacrifices

— Acknowledgements —

The one who inspires me to write books - Guru Sahib.

It is requested that financial assistance be given to distribute the book among the congregation

Bank:- NL89SNSB 0852546688 (NEDERLAND) RATTU D S

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Two Words

Sri Darbar Sahib is not only for Sikhs but is a great, common pilgrimage for all, and it has manifested with the permission of Akal Purakh (God) himself. Satgurus manifest in the world to perform and get such tasks done, and they illuminate the world with righteous deeds and then merge back into the lap of Akal Purakh. But the services or tasks performed by them bestow blessings upon the world, showing the path and reforming lives. Although hundreds of books have been published about Sri Darbar Sahib, with the Guru's permission, I too have begun to write a book, and I have not done the work of just filling pages.

By the Guru's grace, I have written substantial content, not just filled pages.

What sentiments the readers hold, time will surely show the result.

Sometimes a point is repeated, or as needed, it flashes three times, which is the need of the moment, but still, an effort has been made that the book is acceptable to the reader.

It is difficult for readers to read large books now. A topic that can be one or two, or at most three pages, but to read or see 10-20-70-100 pages on a single topic, I consider it useless.

In the future, I request authors that the essence of a topic should not be more than one to, at most, three pages.

This is not the time to make books large, and the author needs to do the favor of recognizing the reader's pulse. Furthermore, foreigners call Sri Darbar Sahib the "Golden Temple," meaning the Temple of Gold. Foreigners have a desire to know about Sri Darbar Sahib, they respect it - this is a good thing.

We have not paid much attention to people learning about Sikhs and respecting a great religion. While living abroad, I feel this is necessary. Being a Sikh, sometimes people feel strange seeing the turban, but we need to do the work of [spreading] the Sikh identity, and Sri Darbar Sahib is considered a Sikh Temple - Because of this issue, I have written this book, and an attempt will be made to publish it in various foreign languages.

There are many expenses for this, about which I will appeal to the congregation for help on the internet and media. If help is received, this work can be successful; otherwise, I can definitely put the PDF in Punjabi, Hindi, English, and some other languages on the net.

The rest, may the readers understand my sentiment - this book is very necessary - the congregation is great - it will complete the Guru's work.

My 'two words' hold a great sentiment - let us join together to do the Guru's work - this is the work that pleases the Guru. The rest is up to one's own thinking. Thank you

Author - S. Davinder Singh Thamanwal, Holland

6. Why was Sri Harmandir Sahib needed?

The path started by Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji showed the world new ways. The thinking of Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji was very high, pure, and formless, and he is also said to be the form of God himself. His works were for the welfare of all, and everyone respected him. The tradition of collecting and reciting Gurbani continued, progressing to the fifth Guru, Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji. He founded Sri Amritsar Sahib and prepared a Sri Adi Granth of the true Bani (teachings). Along with this, he revived a very grand vision. Before this, several major pilgrimage sites for Hindus had already been established, and hundreds of thousands from the congregation would go for pilgrimage baths. The congregation began to consider the pilgrimage and the ritual of bathing there as sacred. On the other hand, it was the devotion of the followers of Islam to consider Mecca and Medina as holy. At this time, the Sikhs did not have any major pilgrimage site or place for ritual bathing, but wherever the Guru Sahib resided, the congregation would go for *darshan* (to see him). The congregation began to consider the places graced by the Guru Sahibs' footsteps as holy and started paying attention to them, but no special place had been established.

Sri Amritsar was the first major place to be established, where the holy scripture, the Granth, the "ship," was prepared from all the collected Bani, and by establishing Sri Harmandir, it was enshrined (Prakash

Karna), and Baba Buddha Ji was appointed the first Granthi (custodian), starting a new tradition. This was the first holy Sarovar (pool) and the first Sri Granth Ji of the *Dhur Ki Bani* (Bani from the source). This was a very grand policy, which the Sikhs needed. Here, not only Sikhs but also Hindus and other devotees joined with unparalleled devotion, and along with the art of Gurbani being practiced, the mind and body began to become true and pure by taking the holy pilgrimage bath. It became possible here to get liberated from the sins of lifetimes. The grace of Akal Purakh (God) here is such that it became a special pilgrimage site, and the feeling one gets upon arriving here is not easy to describe. Other pilgrimages are also fine, but the bliss one feels here is perhaps nowhere else.

The Guru Sahib knew that it was necessary to create such a pilgrimage and bathing place, which would be common to all, but where every Sikh, upon coming, could feel the devotion, and with the bath, black crows could become white. The Guru Ji, by perceiving Guru Nanak Ji in every word within the Sri Adi Granth, made him the great (Satguru) proclaimer - this proclamation is the spiritual light of the ten Guru Sahibs and a total of 36 true, great enlightened beings (Gurus). The pilgrimage site received world honor, and its rules made it a holy pilgrimage. From the true and pure thought of the Guru Sahib, we learn that the Guru Ji, due to the sentiments written above, deemed it

necessary to create a pilgrimage, and then other pilgrimages began to be built. Hail, Hail Guru Sahibs.

7. Fourteen Jewels

This story is historical, but many preachers narrate it as a fable, and Sikh preachers also connect it with Sri Darbar Sahib, but the author does not vouch for its truth because many people might consider this story as proof and could cause trouble. But I felt it was necessary to write according to the hymn-singers and preachers.

Once, (Durvasa) Ji was going, and he met Indra Ji, who was coming on an elephant. When they had a discussion, Durvasa Ji gave Indra Ji a beautiful necklace of diamonds. But Indra Ji threw the necklace down, and the elephant placed its foot on it, breaking it. Durvasa Ji cursed Indra, saying, "Your arrogance will be shattered". As soon as this affected Indra sitting on the throne, his powers began to wane, and he started to lose his wealth. The *Danavs* (demons) forcibly snatched the throne from Indra, and the gods and goddesses were beaten and chased away by the demons, who then went to Sri Brahma Ji to make a plea. Brahma Ji took them along to Bhagwan (God) to request a remedy. Finally, Bhagwan told them the method of obtaining and drinking *Amrit* (nectar) for their salvation. Now, it was told about Amrit that it should be extracted by churning the ocean.

For this, the next task began. The *Devas* (gods) and *Danavs* (demons) agreed to churn the ocean to prove their own strength. The ocean was vast, and for churning, the Mandara mountain was made the churning rod, and Sheshnag (the serpent) was made the *Netra* (rope). Deviously, the demons were placed at the head of the serpent so that the serpent would strike and kill them. Since the churning rod was not stable at the bottom, Sri Vishnu Ji took the form of a tortoise and stabilized it, and the churning began. The *Ratans* (jewels) that emerged, the first jewel was poison, so when no one would take it, Shiv Ji took and drank it, but stopped it in his throat and did not let it go further, which is why Shiv Ji's neck turned blue, and Shiv Ji also got the name 'Neel Kanth' (Blue Throat). The rest of the jewels kept emerging, and the great saints present there kept taking them. The final jewel was *Amrit* (nectar), which was essential to find or extract. After the *Amrit* was extracted, it was taken to Sri Vishnu, who, to help the *Devas*, took the form of Mohini (a beautiful woman) and enchanted the demons, while the gods began to drink the *Amrit*. When the demons realized the trick, they rose to snatch the *Amrit*, and the gods fled with the pot of *Amrit*. It was a long chase. Wherever the *Amrit* spilled, that place became holy, and finally, they buried it at the site of Sri Darbar Sahib. In due time, it manifested during the time of the Guru Sahibs, and here, Sri Amritsar Sahib and Sri Harmandir Sahib were established.

Note- Once again, it is requested that this is a prevalent story - it is necessary for the author to write it, but the author does not vouch for its truth - no one should object to the author. Note- This place is in Bihar, district Bhagalpur, place Dhaunsi, and the name of the mountain is Mandar (Mandara), which is 1300 km from Delhi.

8. The story of Bibi Rajni

Various stories are associated with Sri Amritsar and Sri Darbar Sahib, which help in understanding the importance and praise of Sri Darbar Sahib. Whatever it may be, this place is not ordinary, and the book tries to clarify this to some extent.

One story is connected with Bibi Rajni, and this story builds faith and strengthens feelings of devotion. A rich and arrogant man from Patti, Rai Duni Chand, had a lot of wealth and was arrogant about it. He would give charity and say, "I am the one giving, this is all mine, I am the giver". People in poor conditions would even call him a great giver, which increased his arrogance day by day, and he began to think of himself as above even God.

He had seven daughters. Six daughters, fearing their father's activities and arrogance, would sing his praises day and night, using words like 'master,' 'god,' and 'giver' to address him, just like ordinary people. All the daughters would tell him that they ate what he provided, but one daughter, Bibi Rajni, refused to say,

"We eat what you provide". At this, Duni Chand became very angry and told his daughter to speak like the other daughters, but Bibi Rajni said, "The giver of all is God". After much trying, Rajni did not change, so he married Bibi Rajni to a disabled (leper) man and threw her out of the house, saying, "Let me see if God gives you food".

Remembering God, Bibi Rajni began to pass her time by carrying her husband in a basket and begging from village to village. Reaching the site of the construction of Sri Amritsar, Bibi left the basket near a *Jhiri* (a small thicket/pool) and went to beg from the houses. The leper, seeing black crows bathing in the *Chhapri* (small pond) near the thicket and turning white, also bathed and became completely healthy, but he kept one hand out of the water, which remained affected by the disease. When Bibi returned and saw a healthy man, she thought this man had killed her husband. Hearing the commotion, some people gathered, and when the matter came to light, the Guru Sahib also arrived. The man told the whole story and also showed the diseased hand. The Guru Sahib also dipped his hand in the water, and it became fine. Now, the Guru Sahib told the congregation about the manifestation of *Amrit* (nectar) there, and then the Sarovar and Darbar Sahib were built here. Bibi Rajni grasped the Guru Sahib's feet and spent the rest of her life serving the Guru Sahib, and proved to her father that the only giver is God. Duni Chand's

arrogance was shattered. The truth came out everywhere, and the Guru Sahib was hailed.

Note: I am an applicant for forgiveness for shortening the story - it becomes a necessity.

9. Sri Harmandir Sahib is the Gurdwara Sahib of the Sikhs

From time to time, some people, with the aim of calling the Sikhs' Harmandir Sahib a Hindu temple, a Shiva temple, a Vishnu temple, etc., try to play a big trick, and their motive is that this Gurdwara, this Mecca, this holy religious place of the Sikhs, for which Sikhs hold the greatest reverence and are ready to make any sacrifice, should be changed into some other sentiment, which will end the name of the Sikhs. This trick has been heard from the beginning until today. Sometimes, people with wrong thinking let out 'hot air,' but why don't those with bad intentions remember the history of those who were destroyed trying to wipe Sri Harmandir into the dust. The history is not very old, but because Sikhs stand for truth and fight against oppression, common people are late in understanding the sentiments of the Sikhs. This tradition continues to this day.

The Sikh Gurus, from Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji to Sri Guru Gobind Singh Ji, had good intentions: "First, Allah created the Light; then, by His creative power, He made all mortal beings." "From the One Light, the entire universe welled up. So who is good, and who is bad?"

(1349) And these intentions will remain. Because of such sentiments, the intentions in Sri Harmandir Sahib and other Gurdwaras are also pure.

Invaders and plunderers deemed it necessary to erase the very existence of Sikhs and have been doing so from the beginning of time until 1984-86 at Sri Harmandir Sahib. Only because of the true sentiment and thought of the Sikh Guru Sahibs, the Sikhs, attached to the truth, could not be finished. And people associate the Sikh religion with Hinduism or some with Muslims or others; they also associate Sri Harmandir Sahib with themselves and commit acts to weaken the Sikhs. But let me make it clear that this Gurdwara Sahib, Harmandir Sahib, Ramdas Sarovar - is related to the Sikhs, but every devotee is allowed to come here. This place, in its creation, has no religious connection with Hindus, Muslims, Buddhists, Jains, Christians, etc. The congregation should not consider this Gurdwara Sahib as built by any non-Sikh, and should not mislead the congregation, so that they do not earn the sin of doing so. The meaning of the four doors is the kindness of the Guru Sahib Ji and the mercy and love for the devotee. From here, respect was given to Sain Mian Mir, and other loving people were embraced. Anyone can bathe and leave healed.

Finally, I will make a final request that this holy place belongs to the Sikh religion, but mercy is shown to all here. No one else should say that "it is ours." For love,

it belongs to everyone, but not by right. The world should pay attention to this matter and understand it.

10. Brief Description of Sri Harmandir Sahib–

To give a description of Sri Harmandir Sahib or to write something about it is not within the capacity of any writer or scholar because it is Hari+Mandir, meaning the temple (home) of Hari (God). Whatever words the Guru himself graciously makes one write, we just keep writing. Thanks to the Guru Sahib.

According to history, you can read the basic information about it many times, and I will continue the next point. Appropriate information has been given from time to time. This place is also said to be the site where the *Amrit* (nectar) that emerged from the churning of the ocean during the war between the gods and demons was buried, but this humble author does not strongly vouch for it; one has to learn history, so I too had to write about this prevalent story.

After this, history confirms that this was a very beautiful place , and it is mentioned that Rishis, Munis, and Saints graced this place with their footsteps and also performed penance. There is also mention of the arrival of Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji and the *darshan* of other Guru Sahibs. It is mentioned that the great Rishi Valmiki Ji graced this place with his footsteps, and that Sri Lav and Kush, the sons of Ram Chandra Ji, also graced this place and were raised here. It is also described that Ram

Chandra Ji's horse was caught by Lav and Kush at Sri Amritsar (at that same place), and in some places, their battle is also described, but some writers or scholars will consider or call this article of mine wrong - I ask their forgiveness.

During the time of the Guru Sahibs, when the time came for its manifestation, the foundation was laid with the land that King Akbar had given to Guru Ji's daughter, Bibi Bhani Ji, by making her his own daughter and writing a deed. When the time came for Sri Guru Ram Das Ji to take on the next responsibilities, such circumstances arose that Guru Ji, even before becoming the Guru, sent prominent Sikhs to that holy place to establish a city. Its foundation began in 1570 AD and the work was largely completed in 1577. The foundation of Sri Harmandir Sahib was laid by the Muslim Pir (saint) Hazrat Mian Mir Ji in December 1588 AD, which held special honor and respect and was a grand sentiment. Before this, the work had been proceeding under the supervision of Baba Buddha Ji. The work began with the permission of Sri Guru Amar Das Ji and was initiated by Sri Guru Ram Das Ji. The Sikh congregations started coming here to do service, have *darshan*, and make their lives successful, and they began to settle, turning the jungle into a celebration. Prominent Sikhs like Baba Buddha Ji and Bhai Gurdas Ji began their service and *darshan* here. The work of construction, by the Guru's grace, is continuing to this day and will continue forever. The construction of the

Guru's building was completed in August-September 1604, and seeing its completion, the Guru Sahib enshrined the Sri Adi Granth and also appointed Baba Buddha Ji as the first Granthi.

11

Although this place was started with the permission of Sri Guru Amar Das Ji, and Sri Guru Ram Das Das Ji performed great tasks, the remaining incomplete tasks were completed by Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, who enshrined (the Granth). And after leveling the pile of holy soil from the Sarovar Sahib's excavation, after the martyrdom of the Fifth Patshah, his son, the Sixth Patshah, Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib, manifested the form of Sri Akal Takht.

The Sarovar has a size, and the bridge (path) leading to the Sri Darbar Sahib within it is 202 feet long and 21 feet wide, and the *Parkarma* (circumambulation path) of Sri Harmandir Sahib is 13 feet. On one side is the Har Ki Pauri, about which you can read more details inside the book. In the holy place below, the Sri Guru Granth Sahib is enshrined, and Kirtan is performed. There are four doors here, whose size is approximately 10 x 8.6 feet. These doors are heavy and very beautiful, but at special times, golden doors are also installed. (Mentioned in the book, please read). The Sri Darbar Sahib building is three-storied, and the height of the ceilings is considerable; for example, the first floor's ceiling is 26 feet 9 inches high. The schedule of Kirtan and the code of conduct (Maryada) proceed according

to the rules written in the book. Here, the devotee offers *Prashad* and also offers money or *Bheta* (offerings) according to their devotion. There is a large crowd of devotees here, and so that other devotees can have *darshan*, you cannot stay for long. You have to go outside along with the rest of the congregation. Some devotees also go to the upper floors - the Maharaj (Granth Sahib) is also enshrined there. On one side of the *Parkarma* is the Har Ki Pauri - read the history inside; on one side, some of the congregation sits outside or returns after completing the *Parkarma*. The path for coming and going is separate, and there is also one VIP path.

12

Whatever one may say, going inside Sri Darbar Sahib makes one feel the sentiment of another world, and many also experience unions with divine souls. The *darshan* here is only obtained through good fortune - this is true. It is not possible to describe its beauty. It is impossible to describe the bliss of the surroundings. Every inch of this place is related to holy souls and martyrs. This is the house of God.

Afghans and other invaders attacked Sri Harmandir Sahib many times and defiled its purity, desecrating the building, but the beloveds of the Guru always made sacrifices to restore its holiness. In 1737, after the great martyrdom of Bhai Mani Singh Ji, Massa (Ranghar) desecrated it in 1740, but history tells his fate. After

Massa, the sinners were locked out of here. In 1746, the Hindu Diwan Lakhpat Rai, to avenge his tyrant brother Jaspat Rai, became an enemy of the Sikhs and desecrated the Sarovar and Darbar. Lakhpat Rai, along with Yahiya Khan, played Holi with the blood of 7,000 Sikhs in the first *Ghalughara* (holocaust) in 1746. Now, a Shaheed Ganj (martyrs' memorial) is built there. But to take revenge for this, the Sikhs, under the leadership of S. Jassa Singh Ahluwalia, killed Salamat Khan and thousands of his soldiers in March 1748, taking control of the management of Sri Harmandir Sahib again. After restoring its sanctity, they celebrated the Vaisakhi of 1748 with great pomp, showing that they were in high spirits (Chardi Kala) with the Guru. After this, Abdali attacked for the second time in 1757, causing destruction and demolishing Sri Harmandir Sahib

13. The size of Darbar Sahib

The work of excavating Sri Darbar Sahib began according to the orders of the Guru Sahib, but different dates are found for this. According to one source, the excavation work began with the first *Takk* (dig) as per the Ardas (prayer), with the permission of Baba Buddha Ji, and the *Takk* was struck by Sri Guru Ram Das Ji with his own hands. According to some writers, it is written as 1577 AD and was completed by 1634 Bikrami. According to this mention, Sri Guru Ram Das Ji named it 'Amarsar' after his Satguru Amar Das Ji, and later it was named Sri Amritsar. Similarly, the Sarovar also had two names: Amarsar and Ramdas. As written in the

book, at this holy place, the *Amrit Kund* (pool of nectar) was in the form of a small pond , and the excavation work of the Sarovar was completed in 1577 AD. Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji completed all the remaining tasks of the Guru Sahibs and manifested Sri Darbar Sahib and Sri Sarovar Sahib as a pilgrimage for the world. At this place, many holy souls and Akal Purakh (God) himself came to perform service, which is why it became famous by the name Har Ki Pauri. Now, everything, whether temporary (Kaccha) or permanent (Pakka), was built. This holy Sarovar is 500 feet long, 490 feet wide, 17 feet deep, and has 11 steps. The steps that remain in the water are 2.25 feet wide and 1.5 feet high. Upon completion, by the Guru's grace, the Sarovar filled with rainwater, and Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji was the first to bathe, then Baba Buddha Ji and prominent Sikhs, along with the congregation, began to bathe, and the ritual bathing started. With the enshrinement of the Adi Sri Granth Sahib, the light of knowledge increased here.

The number of devotees grew, and the passage of time brought about events to extinguish this knowledge and light, which are abundant in this book. In the early days, there was only the Darbar Sahib in the Sarovar Sahib and the bridge to enter it. As time passed, progress was made, temporary areas became permanent, a *Parkarma* (circumambulation path) was built, which is of a good size, and the periphery of the Sarovar Sahib was made permanent. The congregation used to set up camps around the Sarovar. Then, *Serais*

(rest houses) were built along the *Parkarma*, but as the congregation grew, more *Serais* and now even hotels have been built. Now, the city's rush has increased excessively, and there is a proliferation of hotels, but due to increased means of transport, the congregation can have *darshan* in one day and return home. Today, hundreds of years later, there is a change in every aspect of Sri Darbar Sahib due to some novelty, but the sentiment is the same, and [the Guru] is present in the beautiful form of Sri Guru Granth Sahib. The enshrinement within and other information are mentioned in the book. The future is also to be shaped and changed according to the Guru's will - a Sikh accepts the Guru's will (Bhana).

14. Baba Buddha Ji met Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji

In the year 1518, while grazing cattle, the young Bura Ji of Kathunangal met Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji, and hearing his wise words, he was called Buddha Ji, and this great soul is respected by the name Baba Buddha Ji. He was given so much respect that he continued to perform the ceremony of applying the *Tilak* (anointing mark) for the succession of Gurus with his own hands, up to Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib. This is a very big thing. When Guru Sahib asked Baba Buddha Sahib Ji to bring water from this place, he uttered a *Bachan* (prophecy) that nectar would rain here. A vast city will be established here.

Sri Guru Amar Das Ji

In 1549, Sri Guru Angad Dev Ji, along with Satguru Amar Das Ji, came to this holy place. By bathing here, the *Nasoor* (ulcer/sore) on Sri Guru Amar Das Ji's toe was healed, and the importance and light of this place's manifestation became more apparent. In 1564, Sri Guru Amar Das Ji established 22 *Manjis* (centers) for religious preaching, and in 1571, Sri Guru Amar Das Ji, for future tasks, expressed his wish to Bhai Jetha (Sri Guru Ram Das Ji) to establish a city here and initiated the work.

Service by Great Sikhs

When Sri Guru Amar Das Ji sent Sri Bhai Jetha Ji to establish the city, the Guru Sahib also gave orders and sent great Sikh devotees of the Sikh nation with him, among whom were Bhai Gurdas Ji, Baba Buddha Ji, Bhai Salo Ji, Bhai Chandra Bhan Ji, and other Sikhs. Obeying the order, they came to this holy place with Bhai Jetha for service, and day and night, service and meditation began.

The Congregation's Eager Arrival

As the land here was purchased and the paperwork was completed, the work began. The congregation had already started moving with Bhai Jetha, but as the news reached far and wide, the congregation's devotion to perform service here increased, and the numbers grew. Continuous service began to take place; day and night became blissful. The congregation, with great devotion, began to bring their own rations, materials, and items

for the *Langar* (community kitchen). Praises began to be sung all around.

In 1572, the foundation for Sri Santokhsar was laid, and the city was named 'Chak Guru'. The place where Guru Sahib (Guru Sri Ram Das Ji) resided came to be called 'Guru Ke Mahal'. Now the service expanded, and Guru Sahib brought and settled artisans of various skills. In 1577, the Sarovar Sahib was started, wells were also dug for convenience, cattle were brought, and Kirtan began, but the Sarovar was established as a temporary (Kaccha) one.

15. **Baba Buddha Ji**

Baba Buddha Ji has a very prominent name in Sikh history, and everyone has great respect for his services and honor. If anyone wants to ask the definition of service, they can understand the sentiment by looking at the life of Baba Buddha Ji. Baba Buddha Ji's childhood name was Bura. His ancestry was Bhatti Rajput, and they came from Rajasthan in the 12th century. He was born on 7 Katak 1563 Bikrami in the village of Gaggonangal (Kathunangal) to father Sri Bhai Sugha Ji Randhawa and mother Sri Gauran. His father was a strong landowner, the owner of 22 villages. His parents moved to Ramdas, and he used to take the buffaloes for grazing.

When Satguru Nanak Ji came to Ramdas, Bura, at the age of 12, heard the Guru Sahib's preaching, and his destiny awakened. Here, he milked the buffaloes and

offered the milk to the Guru Sahib, and hearing his wise words, the Guru Ji called and proclaimed him 'Buddha' (wise old man) because of his mature talk, and this name stuck with him forever. From this meeting with Sri Guru Nanak, he became the Guru's. Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji also blessed Baba Buddha Ji with the honor of performing the succession ceremony to appoint Sri Guru Angad Dev Ji as Guru. After this, he also received the honor of performing the *darshan* and the *Tilak* ceremony for the 6th Guru Sahib. The honor of the 6th Patshah's birth in the house of Mata Ganga Ji, through the boon received from Baba Ji, was also granted to him by the Guru.

Akbar maintained good relations with the Guru Sahib and once, to win Chittor, Akbar came to Guru Amar Das Ji's court to receive a boon, and after winning, he came for *darshan*. He asked for permission to perform some service, but when the Guru Ji refused to take anything, Akbar, considering Guru Ji's daughter Bibi Bhani Ji as his own daughter, lovingly gave her a *Patta* (deed) for Jhabal, Pargana, and 12 villages. Eventually, that place became the root of Sri Amritsar, and Baba Buddha Ji was made the chief-in-charge of that land and was given the service of farming. The jungle began to flourish.

At the age of seventeen, he was married to Bibi Maroa of Achal village, and in time, they had 4 sons. He was the main head of the 22 *Manjis* (preaching centers) established by the Guru Sahib. When the foundation of

Santokhsar was laid in 1570, Baba Ji was given the responsibility of 'Guru Ka Chak'. When the Sarovar also became famous in 1577, and at the time of the enshrinement at Sri Darbar Sahib, he was also blessed by the Guru Sahib with the honor of becoming the first Granthi. He also supervised the construction of the Sarovar and Darbar at Sri Tarn Taran.

Out of a total lifespan of 125 years, he served the Guru's house for 113 years, and afterward, his son received the honor of applying the Guru *Tilak*. Finally, in 1631 AD, he breathed his last in the hands of the Sixth Patshah, and the Guru Sahib performed his last rites with his own hands. By understanding the great life of Baba Ji, we can make our own lives successful.

16. Three Historical Beri (trees) at Sri Darbar Sahib

Although there was a large cluster of trees at Sri Darbar Sahib in ancient times, as the Sarovar Sahib and Darbar Sahib were constructed here, many trees were removed for this purpose, and now only three Beri trees remain, a brief history of which we are writing below-

1. Dukh Bhanjani Beri-

Near this Beri, there was a *Toba* (pond) of water, and it was here that the Guru Sahib's toe was cured with a herb called *Amrit*. It was here that the leprous husband of the magnate Duni Chand's daughter, Bibi Rajni, was cured of his disease by bathing. It was here that black

crows used to dive and emerge as white. Besides this, many other historical tales, stories, and blessings occurred, and are still occurring today. It was from here that Sri Guru Ram Das Ji struck the first *Takk* (dig) for the Sarovar. It is called the Dukh Bhanjani Beri (The Eradicator of Suffering Beri), and the Sri Guru Granth Sahib is enshrined at two places here, and devotees also bathe here.

2. Ber Baba Buddha Ji-

This holy Beri tree is in a very old state. Sitting at this spot, Baba Buddha Ji used to supervise the service of the Darbar Sahib and Sarovar Sahib. Here, Baba Ji would distribute baskets, hoes, and other necessary items to the congregation for Kar Seva, and also distribute wages to the laborers. Due to its old age, its condition began to deteriorate, but then, by the grace of the Guru Sahib, experts paid attention and made it bear even more fruit than before. The Beri trees are periodically cared for by experts, and the Guru Sahib's grace is flowing.

3. Elachi Beri (Lachi Beri)-

The Lachi Beri is situated in front of Sri Harmandir Sahib, near the Darshani Deori (main entrance). The *bers* (fruit) that grow on it are like *Elachis* (cardamoms), which is why Guru Arjan Dev Ji gave it the name Lachi Beri. Sitting under this tree, the Guru Sahib used to oversee the Kar Seva, and Bhai Salo Ji would supervise. In 1740, the Singhs who came to behead Massa

Ranghar, Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh, tied their horses here and then mounted them to return towards Bikaner. Next to this Beri, a small Gurdwara Sahib was built in 1904 by Bhai Hira Singh Pasauriye, where the recitation of Sri Guru Granth Sahib continues.

17. Ramnik/Ranmik

Relation of Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji and his Grandfather-

Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji's grandfather, Sri Shivram Ji, was a very religious and special person/great soul who lived in God's will. He was a resident of Jamarae Dehra Sahib. In his life, he used to pass through the holy area of Sri Darbar Sahib. Although Sri Darbar Sahib was not established at that time, this holy place has been graced by the footsteps of hundreds of thousands of holy souls, great men, and saints, and this will continue in the future. Every single cell of this place has received the holy touch of the feet of great souls and is filled with the sacrifices of martyrs.

The Place of Penance for Rishis and Munis-

You can read in the book about the beginning of Sri Amritsar Sahib, its various names, and different tales and stories, but still, many other Rishis and Munis have been meditating at this *Ramnik* (beautiful/serene) place since ancient times. Many of them are known by name in history, but many are also hidden, who, along with thousands, lakhs of saints, great souls, and Rishis,

graced this place with their holy footsteps and performed worship - it is a very special place.

The Sri Amritsar Sahib Sarovar was built as a temporary (Kaccha) one, and the foundation of Sri Harmandir Sahib in the middle was laid on the Sangrand of Magh, Sammat 1685 (Year 1588), and it was laid by the Muslim Pir, Sain Mian Mir Ji, who was a loving friend and devotee of Sri Arjan Dev Ji. Both understood and believed in the truth.

Santokha Rishi-

When Sri Amritsar was started, the excavation of the Sarovar for the congregation's pilgrimage bath began. One day during the excavation, upon seeing a pot underneath, the congregation informed the Guru Sahib. When the Guru Sahib carefully had the pot taken out, a Rishi emerged from it, sitting in meditation. He asked which *Yug* (era) was ongoing. The Guru Sahib told him it was Kalyug (the dark age). The Rishi then explained that he had received a curse during Satyug (the age of truth) and was told to perform penance, and that in Kalyug, by the grace of Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji, he would be liberated. The congregation was astonished. The Guru Sahib then placed his hand on Santokh Rishi's head and liberated him. This place is named Santokhsar and is very close to Sri Darbar Sahib.

18. Sain Mian Mir Ji

That land is fortunate where saints, great souls, and Guru Sahibs have placed their feet. After that, the soil

of that place becomes capable of liberating the congregation - this is what happened to the land of Sri Amritsar.

The prevalent story of the 'Nine Jewels' from centuries ago; then, when Emperor Akbar came for the *darshan* of the Guru Sahib, he requested to perform some service. When the Guru Sahib refused to accept anything, Maharaja Akbar, seeing Bibi Bhani Ji, the daughter of Sri Guru Amar Das, sitting nearby, wrote a deed for the land in her name, saying, "I am giving this to my daughter." This land was the land of Sri Amritsar. This holy place had already been graced by Rishis, Munis, Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji, and the second, third, and fourth Guru Sahibs, and in total, 8 Guru Sahibs have placed their feet here. There are also facts that Mahatma Buddha placed his feet here.

After *Amrit* (nectar) manifested at the holy pond site, Sri Guru Ram Das Ji built a deep and beautiful temporary (Kaccha) pond, which became the Amrit Sarovar. The rest of the land for the city's development was purchased by the Guru Sahib from the people of some villages for 700 Akbari Mohars (gold coins), and various types of artisans and business-related people were brought and settled to develop the city.

Sri Guru Amar Das Ji gave the blessed order to Sri Guru Ram Das to start the excavation of the Sarovar on November 6, 1573 (AD), and the first *Takk* (dig) was struck by Sri Guru Ram Das Ji with his holy hands. Then,

Sri Guru Amar Das Ji merged with the Divine Light (passed away), and in 1576 AD, after 13 years, the remaining work was completed. The work started by Guru Ram Das was completed by the fifth Guru Sahib, and while making the Sri Sarovar Sahib permanent (Pakka), the foundation of Sri Harmandir Sahib in the center was laid in January 1588 AD by his loving friend, Sain Mian Mir, in 1588 AD, and all of its work was completed in 1601.

Completing the rest of the work, on August 30, 1604, Baba Buddha Ji was appointed as the first Granthi, and the first *Prakash* (enshrinement) of the Sri Adi Sri Granth Sahib was done at Sri Harmandir Sahib. Now, this became a holy Amrit Sarovar not just for the Sikhs but for the world, which is world-famous today.

At one place, Sita Mata stayed, and the birth of Lav and Kush is also believed to be here. It was from here that these two brothers founded the cities of Lahore and Kasur. Their childhood was spent here. It is said that this is the place where Lakshman was rendered unconscious by Lav and Kush during a battle.

Sain Mian Mir was a Pir deeply imbued in God's love and was very close to the Guru Sahib. The Guru Sahib, to honor him and to give a message of humanity, performed the benevolence of having the foundation laid by a Muslim Pir. Before the Guru Sahib's martyrdom in Lahore, Pir Mian Mir met him at Chandu's *Haveli* (mansion) and asked for permission to (in his anger)

destroy Delhi and Lahore, but the Guru Sahib requested him to accept God's will and abide by its rules. Today, Baba Mian Mir Ji's esteemed name is joined with Sri Darbar Sahib.

19. The Management of Sri Darbar Sahib

As Sri Amritsar Sahib began with various names, which are mentioned in the book, today Sri Amritsar Sahib and Sri Darbar Sahib, or in English, the "Golden Temple," is famous. At the time of the city's construction, prominent Sikhs like Baba Buddha Ji, Bhai Gurdas Ji, Bhai Bidhi Chand Ji, Bhai Kalyan Ji, Bhai Jetha Ji, Bhai Salo Ji, Bhai Behlo Ji, and other Sikhs began to live day and night, dedicated to the Guru Sahib. The Guru Sahib, with a very good arrangement, entrusted them with the tasks of management, which continued with great grace. The congregation was so true and pure that they had no other desire than the spirit of service. All tasks were completed in high spirits (Chardi Kala).

After the martyrdom of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, changes and difficulties arose, but his son and the sixth Guru, Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib, brought a new turn to the management. He combined devotion and power (Bhagti and Shakti) and established a throne, which the plundering rulers began to see as a threat, but the Guru Sahib's throne remained firm, which the administration could not shake. Battles also began to be fought from here, a new tradition. The Sikhs remained in high spirits,

and the management continued under the Guru Sahib's command.

When the Guru Sahib came from Sri Amritsar Sahib to Kiratpur Sahib in 1691 AD, the management here was taken over by his uncle Prithi Chand's son, Meherban, in collaboration with the Delhi government, fulfilling his wish - this was indeed a capture. But after his death in 1696 Bikrami, his (son) remained in control until his death in 1753 Bikrami. His three sons got entangled over the control and moved away from Sri Amritsar Sahib. At this time, Sri Guru Gobind Singh Ji was gracing the Guru's throne; he sent Bhai Mani Singh with some Singhs to take over the management and other responsibilities. The situation improved, and the congregation increased greatly. Kirtan began, and that same *Maryada* (code of conduct) continues in high spirits today.

According to the times, this management is now running under the control of the SGPC. Back then, *Katha* (discourse) was also held here along with Kirtan, but now only Kirtan is performed. To maintain this management, several factions, with government help, also took control by force, and internal conflicts also occurred, but Sri Guru Ram Das Ji ultimately made the truth victorious, and it will continue to be so in the future. Whoever commits fraud against Sri Darbar Sahib, their reckoning can be read in history. A bad intention towards even a single penny, object, or item here leads to a clear result. It is the first duty of the

managers to always keep historical facts in mind and act judiciously. The consequence of policies made here for one's own benefit turns out very bad - you can see history.

20. Langar Hall

The tradition of *Langar* (community kitchen) started from the time of the Guru Sahib. Even before the Guru Sahib, during the time of the great souls related to the Sri Guru Granth Sahib, the congregation used to come in large numbers for *darshan*. In those times, resources were scarce, and the congregation had to face many hardships to come. It would take many months to come on foot, but now it has become easy.

I once had to take a flight from Sri Amritsar Sahib to LHR (London Heathrow). My friend from Bhogpur (Jalandhar) came to drop me off at Sri Amritsar Sahib. Sitting in Sri Amritsar Sahib, as we sat for morning tea, he said, "It's amazing, Davinder Ji, breakfast in Sri Amritsar, lunch in the sky on the plane, three (o'clock) in London, and the remaining hunger (satiated) at home in LHR." It is true, the pilgrimage that used to take months can now be done by going in the morning and returning home at night, but in ancient times, it used to take more than months, even a year. Because of this, the tradition of *Langars* was very important.

During the time of the Guru Sahib, arrangements for *Langar* and accommodation began for the visiting congregation, but as time passed, facilities increased,

and arrangements improved. Sri Darbar Sahib became the first major pilgrimage site for Sikhs. Here, the congregation probably used to make their own arrangements for accommodation and *Langar* initially, and then arrangements were made. The Guru Sahib himself prepared and served *Langar* to the congregation. As the congregation grew, the *Langar* arrangements became better with excellent management.

In 1897, Maharaja Bikram Singh of Faridkot offered an Ardas of 75,000 rupees for the Langar Hall and built the Langar Hall. In 1923, during the Kar Seva, the Langar Hall building was expanded, a service undertaken by Baba Kharak Singh Ji along with Baba Darshan Singh Ji, preparing five stories, with the *Langar* running on the second and third floors. There is accommodation on the fourth floor and *Prakash* (enshrinement) on the fifth. The basement used to have a flour mill and storage, but now the Langar Hall here is modern, where, keeping in mind the changes and facilities according to the times, lakhs of devotees eat *Langar* and perform service in the *Langar*. It is the world's largest kitchen. The *Langar* runs 24 hours, and the expenses are in crores (tens of millions). The *Langar* is free, and learning about it in detail, people are astonished how it is possible to spend so much, but by the Guru Ji's grace, it is expanding day by day.

21. Special for Sri Darbar Sahib

- Continuous Kirtan from the time of *Prakash* (enshrinement) until *Sukh Asan* (conclusion).
- A continuous flow of the congregation from *Prakash* to *Sukh Asan*.
- Ardas (prayer) is offered multiple times.
- The *Hukamnama* (edict of the day) is taken multiple times.
- Cleaning arrangements continue constantly.
- Cold, sweet water is available all day at the *Chhabeels* (water stalls).
- The facility to buy flower garlands in the *Parkarma* (circumambulation path).
- Bathing is available all day according to the rules.
- Even a person of the highest rank behaves according to the rules.
- Facility for *Prashad*.
- Special bathing house for ladies.
- Facility to sit in the *Parkarma* after finding a suitable time and place.
- Only Gurbani Kirtan.
- No lectures or preaching.
- The custom of moving peacefully.
- Talking is prohibited.
- No one from outside can perform Kirtan without permission.
- No one can engage in politics.
- No *Siropao* (robe of honor) for an apostate (*Patit*).
- Only Akal Purakh (God), Guru Sahib, and Gurbani can be praised.

- The *Saroop* (form) of Sri Guru Granth Sahib is brought in a revered *Palki* (palanquin) from Sri Akal Takht Sahib, from the Sri Kotha Sahib, and is enshrined (Prakash) in Sri Darbar Sahib.
- Special attention is paid to cleaning every day.
- *Langar* is prepared and served 24 hours a day.
- Rain, storm, gale, typhoon, night, day, sorrow, happiness, sun, shade... etc., do not affect the sentiments of the congregation.
- One must cover their head to enter.
- It is strictly forbidden to do, or bring, any intoxicant inside.
- The functions proceed only according to the rules established within, and no one can break these rules.
- There is only the tradition of Sri Guru Granth Sahib here, no tradition of any living Guru (*Deh Dhari*)... etc.

22. Rules for the visiting congregation

- When a devotee starts from their home for *darshan* (viewing), they bathe, put on clean clothes, cover their head, and then set out.
- Upon reaching Sri Darbar Sahib, the first thing they do is deposit their shoes and any belongings and get a token.
- Chanting "Satnam Waheguru" with every breath, they then proceed to the specially made place (basin) with clean water, dip their feet to wash them, and descend the stairs into the holy *Parkarma* (circumambulation path).

- When entering, their head must be covered , and it is strictly forbidden to wear socks or to bring any intoxicant or tobacco inside one's pocket.
- Upon reaching the *Parkarma*, one walks to the left, chanting the *Jaap* (meditation).
- Here, it is essential to keep one's attention only on the Kirtan.
- Talking about worldly matters is not permitted.
- Further ahead, near the right turn at the holy Beri tree, there is an arrangement for bathing, and there is an arrangement for Sri Guru Granth Sahib, where recitation continues.
- Bathing is to be done with care, and swimming is prohibited.
- Using soap is also not permitted; wet clothes can be wrung out outside.
- There is a special place for ladies, and guards are present at this spot to prevent any accident.
- A large number of devotees are present near this spot.
- At the next turn (corner), a little further on, is the martyrdom site of Shaheed Baba Deep Singh, where devotees pay their respects and have *darshan*.
- A large number of devotees are present here.
- At the next turn is the office for *Karah Prashad*, and after taking *Prashad* from here, it is brought inside Sri Darbar Sahib.
- Ahead is the Darshani Deori (main entrance) and the Lachi Beri, where the Singhs who came to punish

Massa Ranghar, Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh, had tied their horses.

- From here, passing through the Darshani Deori, one can proceed towards Sri Harmandir Sahib via the bridge.
- There is a path for going and one VIP path.
- Due to the rush at Sri Darbar Sahib, there is a long line, and the congregation enters in turn.
- Bowing one's head at the door, one must hand over the platter of Sri *Karah Prashad* to the organizers, and they give you a small amount of *Prashad* back.
- The Sri Guru Granth Sahib is enshrined here.
- Here, you can bow your head at the designated place and offer devotion and money.
- Some of the congregation can sit behind the *Raagis* (hymn-singers) for some time, but not for a long time.
- Due to the rush here, it is impossible to stay for long.
- Exiting from the left door and doing the *Parkarma*, some people sit down.
- Some of the congregation also goes for *darshan* on the upper floor, where the Maharaj (Granth Sahib) is also enshrined.

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- From here, one has to exit via the return path, across the bridge, and *Karah Prashad* is received near the Darshani Deori.

- Taking photos or making films inside the main building (Imarat) of Sri Darbar Sahib is prohibited, but it is allowed in the remaining areas.
- Some people used to make films for TikTok or their personal work; they are banned.
- There are water *Chhabeels* (stalls) in the *Parkarma* from where you can drink water.
- The congregation can sit in the verandas of the rooms built in the *Parkarma*, and with special permission, one can get permission to stay.
- From the *Parkarma*, you can have *darshan* of Sri Akal Takht Sahib, the martyrdom place of Baba Gurbakhsh Singh, and the place of Shaheed Baba Deep Singh.
- While going back or coming in, you can visit the museum.
- You can participate in the cleaning by joining the organizers.
- While walking inside, you cannot use your phone; it is necessary to walk silently and peacefully.
- From the *Parkarma*, you can go to the Langar Hall and other holy places.
- Special devotees are given a *Siropao* (robe of honor) from Sri Darbar Sahib and Sri Akal Takht Sahib.
- You can have *darshan* and perform service for the *Palki Sahib* (palanquin) in the early morning (*Amrit Vela*).
- You can be present for service at the time of *Sukh Asan* (conclusion ceremony) in the evening.

- After having *darshan* of Sri Darbar Sahib and completing the *Parkarma*, you can go outside to the *Jora Ghar* (shoe-keeping house), collect your shoes, and make purchases according to your devotion from the shops built outside.
- Another request is that there are some other traditions as well, the main purpose of which is to maintain respect and uphold the traditions.
- This rule is equal for all, and it is necessary to follow it.
- So, O Holy Congregation, please kindly learn and follow even more rules - this is the path to make this life successful.
- It is necessary to follow, and following is worthy of thanks.

24. Karah Prashad

The exact details of the tradition of *Karah Prashad* in the Sikh religion are not known, but it is possible that it started from the *Prashad* brought to Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji at the site of Sri Darbar Sahib, as mentioned in the book. But it is possible that other scholars may have more information. For the rest, it requires equal amounts of sugar, ghee (clarified butter), and flour, and double the amount of water. The sugar is dissolved in boiling water, and the flour is roasted in the ghee (butter). When the flour is roasted, the sweet water is added, and it is stirred over a low flame to thicken it. When it thickens a bit, the heat is turned off, and it must be transferred to a special *Prashad* vessel and kept.

After this, at the appropriate time, the *Prashad* is distributed to the congregation after an Ardas (prayer) and *Bhog* (offering). Where the general congregation's arrival is regular, it is made daily as needed, but where the congregation does not come every day, *Prashad* in the form of *Phullian* (puffed rice), *Mishri* (rock sugar), *Patase* (sugar drops), almonds, etc., is given to the devotee. Every devotee, sitting on the ground with their head covered, receives the *Prashad* in their cupped hands, touches it to their forehead, and partakes of it while thanking the Guru Sahib. The *Prashad* cannot be dropped on the ground. *Prashad* received to take home can be properly packed or taken from the Granthi or manager and brought home. *Prashad* is not meant to fill the stomach; rather, it is given in small, equal amounts to all. *Prashad* is given to every devotee according to the rules, without discrimination. At Sri Darbar Sahib and other large historical Gurdwaras, quintals (hundreds of kilos) of *Prashad* are made daily. At Sri Darbar Sahib, we are also providing the ingredients in the book. You can estimate the rest; nearly one lakh (100,000) devotees come here every day, and everyone receives *Prashad*. On special days, the number of devotees doubles or even quadruples. During times of natural disasters, *Langar* and *Prashad* are also delivered to the congregation or deserving people. Some people add cashews, raisins, almonds, and dried fruits to the *Karah Prashad*, and some make the *Prashad* from *Sooji* (semolina). This can be called

Halwa, but not *Prashad*. *Prashad* is made only from wheat flour using the method described above. This is the identity of *Prashad*.

25. The Kitchen (Langar) of Sri Darbar Sahib

The kitchen of Sri Darbar Sahib is the world's largest and most special kitchen providing free *Langar*. Although the tradition of *Langar* was started by Sri Guru Nanak Sahib, and it existed before him, the rules that the Guru Sahibs established within Sikhism are the best in the world. Here, *Langar* for 100,000 to 200,000 devotees is made on normal days, but on special occasions and *Gurpurabs* (festivals), this number certainly increases manifold. To make this *Langar*, *Patile* (large pots), *Sagle* (cauldrons), and *Karahis* (woks) that are 7-8 feet wide and even wider are used. The *Langar* is made 4-5 times every day and is continuously cooked. In the 24-hour *Langar*, tea is also always available. The *Langar* typically consists of *Daal* (lentils), *Sabji* (vegetable curry), *Chawal* (rice), *Roti* (bread), *Achar* (pickle), and a sweet dish or salad. The *Langar* is 100% vegetarian. There is also a facility for warm milk for small children. In the kitchen, the floor is cleaned after short intervals, and cleaning is also done in the Langar Hall. There is an elevator in the Langar Hall so that the *Langar* being prepared on other floors can reach the correct place. The *Langar* is prepared with the help of excellent automatic machines, but the *Daals*,

vegetables, and some other *Langar* items are prepared by experienced Sikhs in large vessels. An automatic machine makes 7,000 *Roti* (breads) in one hour, but devotees also prepare 1,000-1,500 *Prashade* (rotis) per hour with their own hands. The *Langar* is distributed hot to the congregation. Hundreds of *Sevadars* (volunteers) and employed staff perform the service of cutting vegetables, onions, and tomatoes every day. The Sri Guru Ram Das Rasoi (Kitchen) is very large, and here, absolutely free and very tasty *Langar* is available for everyone. Every day, at least two lakh (200,000) *Prashade*, 1.5 tonnes of *Daal*, 25 quintals (2,500 kg) of grain, 100 gas cylinders, 5,000 kg of wood, and the count of onions, garlic, tomatoes, chilies, tins of ghee, spices, milk, yogurt... is impossible to measure. To wash lakhs of utensils, there are special machines, and the congregation shows great enthusiasm for washing by hand, and the utensils are washed very purely in a three-step process. The vessels are so large that 700 kg of *Daal* can be cooked at one time. There is also a special machine for distributing water. The congregation considers it a privilege to perform free service here, and thousands, including kings and maharajas, come and wash utensils and serve in and partake of the *Langar*. To eat the *Langar*, one must sit in *Pangats* (rows), and before eating, *Jaikare* (victory slogans) are shouted. The expense here is in lakhs and crores (millions), but by the Guru Sahib's grace, there has never been any shortage. If you want to sign up to

sponsor the *Langar* today, your turn will come in 10-15 years. There is a *Langar* tradition in almost every Gurdwara Sahib, and this same custom exists in foreign countries as well. In times of hardship, the Guru's Sikhs set up *Langars* everywhere, and the *Langar* is distributed with great devotion. Where food *Langars* are set up, the Guru's Sikhs also serve other necessary items. No devotee can leave Sri Darbar Sahib or other Gurdwara Sahibs hungry. Blessed are the Guru Sahib and the principles.

26. Miracles at Sri Harmandir Sahib

It is also said about Sri Darbar Sahib that this holy place has existed for ages upon ages, but it was manifested during the time of the Guru Sahib. The rest, when scholars agree with this idea, a wave of agreement will start, but if they resort to criticism, they go as far as skinning the author or preacher. These are all profound matters, and to understand them, a grand and high level of thinking is also necessary. The same applies to the *Dhur Ki Bani* (Bani from the source), and when someone's own composition came, the Guru Sahib refused to include it. Besides this, miracles or the play of divine power at this holy place have been seen hundreds of thousands of times to this day. First, the black (crow) turning white, the leper's disease being cured; after that, the warriors and heroes confronting tyranny, the beheading of Massa Ranghar, Bhai Vir Singh, Bhai Mani Singh, Shaheed Baba Deep Singh, Baba Gurbakhsh Singh, etc., are examples of ancient

divine power at play. In other words, calling it a miracle makes it easy for a Sikh to understand. After that, even today, many dangerous diseases, the blind, cancer, inability to walk, the lame, the crippled, the mute, and many others... the divine power continues to work, and in the time to come, whoever comes with faith in the Guru will receive their heart's desires. Even today, there is no lack of devotion, and when a devotee comes to Sri Darbar Sahib with hope and faith, the grace bestowed by the Guru Sahib can be called a miracle, the play of divine power, or whatever word feels right. Actually, in the Sikh religion, miracles are not respected, and the Guru Sahib had expelled Baba Ram Rai from the family for displaying miracles. Sikhs understand and respect the word "miracle" as the "play of the Guru's divine power". The Guru Sahib's (encounter with) Koda the demon, Bali Kandhari, Sajjan the thug, Baba Banda Singh Bahadur being mounted on the *Charkhri* (spiked wheel), having limbs cut joint by joint - some people call this a miracle, some call it grace, and some call it the play of divine power. I hope you will understand the sentiments. Thank you.

27. SGPC and its work

From the time of the Guru Sahib, Sikhs have been following the rules of Sri Darbar Sahib and others with responsibility. In those times, there was so much contentment that whoever performed service, or whatever the Guru Sahib assigned, or the Sikhs

themselves would dedicate themselves and serve - its form was the spirit of service. The names of those Sikhs who performed these services are written in golden letters in history. The names mentioned in the book are those who were present day and night in tasks such as managing alongside the Guru Sahib, writing (transcribing) Gurbani, performing service with integrity, fulfilling responsibilities, and serving moment by moment during construction. You can read the names in the book. The Jathedar Sahibs were also, in a way, managers of great services or, in other words, administrators who were very serious about the rules and were ready to make every sacrifice. This tradition had been going on for centuries, but as times changed, when it became necessary to adapt many things, it was given the name of a 'Committee' or 'Management Committee'. Finally, in 1920, after much deliberation, the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) was formed, which would manage Gurdwara Sahib Sri Darbar Sahib and other Sikh affairs or rules, and make every effort to keep everyone in high spirits (Chardi Kala). The leaders organized this committee with great thought, and the formation of the committee was necessary. Because external forces had taken a dangerous turn of occupation, infiltration, capture, and misuse of religious practices. The committee made various sacrifices to improve the management of the Gurdwaras. This committee then became certified for Gurdwaras in Hindustan and

foreign countries. Now, although this committee is becoming political along with religious, still, thousands of other committees are being formed and engaging in politics, but its authenticity among Sikhs remains intact. Today, this committee is also legally recognized and is responsible for the total management of the Gurdwaras. Its election is now done by members, and in 2024-25, the President is S. Harjinder Singh Dhami. May pure services continue in the time to come, and may the Guru Sahib grant the committee the strength to follow the rules. These tasks are documented.

28. Righteous Warriors

The author has tried to clarify the importance or mention of Sri Darbar Sahib as much as possible in the book, and countless other books and preachers also describe it. The righteous warriors who make sacrifices for Sri Darbar Sahib cannot be ignored. Whenever there is a need for any kind of service or sacrifice, the righteous warriors and *Sevadars* (volunteers) present themselves for every service and sacrifice. This tradition has been going on from the very beginning. It is impossible to count these warriors. Hundreds of thousands of warriors are known, but still, hundreds of thousands perform secret services and make their lives successful. There is a need to show seriousness in writing history so that the importance of Sri Darbar Sahib can be further illuminated to the world. We should always respect the righteous warriors and those who perform services.

The Source of Power

Sri Darbar Sahib is the source of power, and by taking power from here, a devotee finds the path to cross the ocean of existence. There is no room for doubt, but if anyone needs proof, they can come to Sri Darbar Sahib according to the rules, and they will get the proof. From focusing one's attention here to starting the journey for *darshan*, what one feels upon reaching the holy place, the result itself will become the proof. Every cell here is a home of praise and is proof. Coming here creates such a sentiment that life changes. The path to liberation becomes easy. Servants and warriors come here, offer Ardas (prayers), and obtain power. There are crores (tens of millions) of proofs of people obtaining everything from worldly tasks to spiritual power. Any devotee who comes here with faith, whether they are a Sikh or a non-Sikh, their attendance is marked. If you wish, you can conduct a survey at Sri Darbar Sahib for one day, and you will find that a large number of non-Sikh devotees come for *darshan*. It is a fortunate thing that Sikhs, for whom it is possible, begin their lives by taking power from here.

29. Entry

There are some rules regarding entry into Sri Darbar Sahib. The first rule every devotee must learn is to bathe at home before coming. Wear clean clothes, adorn a *Dastar* (turban), cover the head, and upon reaching Sri Darbar Sahib, first deposit shoes and socks

(at the *Jora Ghar* / shoe house). At the time of entry, one must pass their feet through the water basin built there and then proceed. But it is essential to try to maintain a pure sentiment for the Guru Sahib and Darbar Sahib, and the yearning for *darshan* in the heart. If a devotee goes in this state, the Guru will surely bestow grace.

Rules

- The first rule is to bathe before leaving home for entry and to be clean.
- You cannot take any intoxicants, nor can you go after consuming them.
- Before entry, it is necessary to remove shoes and socks and to have one's head covered.
- After washing feet in the basin, proceed to the *Parkarma*, and as soon as you have *darshan*, you must bow.
- Do not talk about random things. Listen to the Kirtan being broadcast and perform the *Parkarma*.
- Further on, one bathes at the designated bathing spot. Then, proceeding in the *Parkarma*, have *darshan* of the Baba Deep Singh *Asthan* (place), then take *Prashad* (Degh), stand in line to have *darshan* inside, and then come out chanting "Waheguru Waheguru".

Upon Committing Sacrilege

Every single inch of Darbar Sahib reminds us of the sacrifices of the martyrs and their importance, but many people, not understanding these sentiments, commit sacrilege. Those who commit sacrilege here have to endure suffering here and hereafter. Therefore, respect the Guru and continue your *darshan*. History vividly tells the tale of those who committed sacrilege. Read the history of Ahmad Shah Abdali, Massa Ranghar, Indira Gandhi, etc.. In the future, whoever commits sacrilege, the Sikhs do not forgive them because Sri Darbar is dearer to the Sikhs than life - they can be martyred for it. Waheguru Ji.

30. Kirtan Rules

The tradition of Kirtan at Sri Darbar Sahib has been ongoing from the very beginning, and the prayer is that it continues forever. But during difficult times, this *Maryada* (code of conduct) has also been broken. The Sikhs, by the Guru's grace, have made history and kept this rule constant. Those who used the power of the state to break this *Maryada*, their very existence has been erased. It is a request and a warning that no one should make the mistake of thinking they are great by confronting Sri Darbar Sahib or any religious place. Blessings have been received by those who come here with humility - this is the only conclusion.

Several Excellent Kirtan-singers-

Very excellent, soulful Kirtan-singers (*Kirtaniye*) perform service here, and when the sound of the

Gurbani *Shabads* (hymns) enters the ears, a very divine feeling is created, and hearts become peaceful. Those who are receptive can reach liberation. Many people also describe their experiences of the sweet melodies of Kirtan and the special power to create art within the *Raag* (musical mode). The great *Kirtaniya* from here, Bhai Sahib Bhai Nirmal Singh Khalsa, being honored with a high status by the President of India, is a matter of pride. This clearly shows the status of the *Kirtaniyas* - this is a great mercy of the Guru Sahib.

Recommended Kirtan-singers, Sevadars-

Sometimes, politics is also practiced here by the managers through recommendations, but its result does not remain hidden. Come here after becoming pure and fill your laps with all kinds of auspicious wishes from life. The work done through recommendations is a sin, and one who commits sin here, or at any religious place, is never forgiven in God's court. It is requested that those who make recommendations, misuse (power), commit faithlessness, take bribes, and break rules should change their ways and maintain a spirit of devotion. This is the house of God, and here, one should not feel their own presence, but always feel the presence of Akal Purakh (God) - peace will prevail.

31. Bathing

The tradition of bathing has been ongoing with respect from the very beginning. The devotee's sentiment for

darshan and *ishnan* (bathing) here has remained intact for centuries. This gives a special energy, and the washing away of lifetimes of filth is a true and pure thought, but it is also necessary for the devotee to come with a pure heart. From the beginning, the rule has been that bathing here holds great importance. A devotee comes and takes a *dubbi* (dip) in the holy water, but they cannot use soap, shampoo, or anything else, nor can they scrub their body to wash off dirt. These same rules are still in effect. This rule is for everyone. Here, king and pauper bathe as one, and it is blissful.

Rules-

- Here, the bathing aspirant, wearing clothes or a *Kachh* (undergarment) but wearing other clothes and covering their head, goes towards the water.
- One must wear a large *Kachha* (long shorts), *Safa* (head covering), etc., and can hand over their (outer) clothes to someone in the *Parkarma* before bathing at the designated bathing side of the Sarovar.
- -On the Sarovar's steps, one is advised to hold the chain while descending, as there is a risk of falling due to the slippery steps.
- -Furthermore, using soap, shampoo, or scrubbing while bathing in the Sarovar is forbidden, and swimming or going further into the middle is strictly forbidden.

- -Upon coming out, it is instructed to wring out wet clothes outside. There is a special place for ladies on this same side.
- -It is necessary to maintain peace here.

Guardianship-

- During bathing, a special team of *Sevadars* (volunteers) keeps watch over the bathing aspirants, so that no one goes into danger in the water.
- -Here, generally, everyone pays attention and shows reverence, always bathing with humility.
- -One special thing is that bathing here is only possible through good fortune.
- -The rest, here generally, no mishap ever occurs, and lakhs of devotees have *darshan*, bathe, and make their lives successful.
- -The congregation is requested to take care of their own belongings.
- -The rest, the Guru Sahib himself protects the congregation that comes to his house and bestows blessings.
- "Bathing in the Sarovar of Ram Das, all committed sins are washed away."

32. Water bottles

On one side of Sri Darbar Sahib is the Har Ki Pauri, from where the congregation takes bottles of holy water to their homes and, by sprinkling it and drinking it, considers themselves fortunate. Devotees have a great

devotion to taking this holy water to countries near and far. You can buy plastic bottles from the shops and take the water. The rest, the history of Har Ki Pauri is that when the construction was ongoing, a person who was doing service by carrying a basket... the congregation was amazed to see the basket moving along, but above his head. When they reported this to the Guru Sahib, the Guru Sahib, to clear the doubt, went with that person and saw for himself. The person then revealed that he was Akal Purakh (God) himself and had come to perform service.

Darshan by good deeds-

The importance of Sri Darbar Sahib is far beyond what a pen can write, and it is impossible for any person to write it. Worldly writers or even great souls only speak or write a little by the Guru's grace. But this is the place where Akal Purakh Sahib himself lifted a basket and performed Kar Seva. Crores (tens of millions) of saints, great souls, gods, goddesses, and martyrs have placed their feet and performed service here. Every inch of this holy land has received the holy touch of the martyrs' guard and the feet of great souls. *Darshan* here is only obtained through good deeds - if someone says "I am going to go," that is wrong - only the one upon whom He bestows grace can have *darshan*.

Martyrdom everywhere-

From ages past, this holy place holds great importance, and since its manifestation, Sikhs have... you know its

precious value, and history tells how much this place was targeted by plunderers and how the warriors and heroes made sacrifices to maintain its sanctity. Every inch of this land is stained with the blood of martyrdom. It is only with spiritual insight that this fact can be understood. A guard of martyrs remains here, and because of these great powers, the consequence of any bad intention or act of sacrilege here can be seen in history. Blessed are the martyrs and the great souls who always bestow their grace here.

33. Which Guru Sahibs graced this place with their feet?

First of all, even before the Guru Sahibs, there are stories of Rishis and Munis coming to this serene place to perform penance and meditation. But during his *Udasis* (travels), Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji came here with Baba Mardana Ji and performed Kirtan. Here, Tara, the *Chaudhary* (headman) of Sultanwind and a Gursikh, prepared and presented *Prashad* to Baba Guru, and the Guru Sahib was pleased. According to some writings, the tradition of *Karah Prashad* started from here, but the author cannot provide proof of this. Once, the Guru Ji also asked Baba Buddha Ji to bring and drink water from here. According to information, only Sri Guru Gobind Singh Ji and Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji were unable to go inside Harmandir Sahib during their time. But they were never far from here - by closing their

eyes, they were omnipresent. All the other Guru Sahibs graced this place with their feet.

The Gurus themselves were stopped-

When Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji manifested in his Guru form, he came to Sri Darbar Sahib. At that time, the management of Sri Darbar Sahib was in the hands of the *Mahants* (hereditary priests). They suspected that if the Guru Sahib set up his camp here, they would have to get out. The *Mahants* had taken control to loot the incoming offerings and swallow the *Bheta* (donations) from the visiting congregation. Along with the Guru Sahib was Bhai Makhan Shah Lubana and some of his *fauj* (companions). When the *Mahants* saw the Guru Sahib coming towards the door of Sri Darbar Sahib, they quickly shut the doors. The congregation knocked on the doors, but they did not open them. Bhai Makhan Shah Ji requested the Guru Ji to give him permission, and he would, with his Sikhs, open the door himself and throw the *Mahants* out. But the Guru Sahib stopped him, telling him not to do so. The Guru Sahib then went and sat on a *Thara* (platform) quite far from here. As the congregation found out, the entire city began to come for *darshan*. The women (Maiyan) served the Guru Sahib greatly, and the Guru Ji gave them the boon of "Maiyan Rabb Rajaiyan" (Women are blessed by God's will). Today, the Gurdwara Thara Sahib is established at that platform site. From here, the Guru Sahib went towards Sri Kartarpur Sahib and traveled far and wide for preaching, to bless the congregations.

34. The First Ten Granthi Sahibs of Sri Darbar Sahib

1. Baba Buddha Ji (First Granthi Sahib)
2. Bhai Mani Singh Ji
3. Sant Gopal Das Ji Udasi
4. Bhai Chanchal Singh Ji
5. Bhai Atma Singh Ji
6. Bhai Sham Singh Ji
7. Bhai Jassa Singh Ji
8. Bhai Jawahar Singh Ji
9. Bhai Harnam Singh Ji
10. Bhai Fateh Singh Ji and the current ones are also worthy of respect.

The Sarbarahs (Managers) of Sri Darbar Sahib-

1. During the Sikh Raj, S. Lehna Singh was the manager of Darbar Sahib. Then the British appointed -
2. S. Jodh Singh, Extra Assistant Commissioner.
3. S. Mangal Singh Ramgarhia, Honorary Magistrate.
4. S. Maan Singh, Risaldar Major.
5. S. Arjan Singh, Honorary Magistrate.
6. S. Jwala Singh, Colonel.
7. S. Jwala Singh, Karn.

The Jathedars of Sri Akal Takht Sahib-

1. Bhai Gurdas Ji was the first Jathedar (Scribe of Sri Guru Granth Sahib)

2. Bhai Mani Singh Ji
3. Nawab Kapur Singh Ji
4. S. Jassa Singh Ahluwalia Ji
5. Akali Baba Phula Singh Ji
6. Akali Hanuman Singh Ji
7. Akali Prahlad Singh Ji
8. S. Aroor Singh of Naushehra
9. Teja Singh Bhuchar
10. Teja Singh Akarpuri and others, after whom Now, according to the Sarbat Khalsa, Bhai Jagtar Singh Hawara is the Jathedar, but on the other hand, Giani Raghbir Singh Ji is also recognized. (In the year 2024). Dhian Singh Mand considers himself the acting Jathedar. The author asks for forgiveness.

35. The Great Tosha Khana (Treasury)

Maharaja Ranjit Singh and some other Maharajas also performed great works for the Gurdwaras from early times, because their sentiment was that their kingdom and whatever they had was all the wealth of the Guru Sahib. The greatest service is that of Maharaja Ranjit Singh. Wherever he liked a valuable, fine item, he would buy it and have it offered at Sri Harmandir Sahib. The service of his family is a great service, whose name will last for as long as the world exists. Even today, the services offered by him in the Tosha Khana are great, and other Sikh Sardars also offered valuable services

and offerings at Sri Harmandir Sahib. The following valuable offerings are mentioned:-

Jeweled Chhatar (Canopy)-

A golden canopy weighing ten *ser* (approx 9.3kg) with a circumference of three feet. A peacock is made on its top, and a sapphire is embedded in its neck. The beauty of the peacock's beak is further enhanced by a pure pearl, which is in the form of a necklace. The number of diamonds, emeralds, and jewels on the canopy is 37, and strings of diamonds and jewels are also hanging. This canopy was offered as a service by Maharaja Ranjit Singh.

Sehra (Groom's Headdress)-

A *Sehra* was made for the wedding of Maharaja Ranjit Singh's grandson, Kanwar Nau Nihal Singh, in which 2,953 diamonds, rubies, jewels, and precious pearls are embedded, and strings of pearls are hanging. According to information, the cost of the *Sehra* at that time was over ten lakh (one million) rupees, which is equivalent to many *arbs* (billions) today. When the Maharaja saw this *Sehra*, he said that this *Sehra* was made only to be an offering at Sri Darbar Sahib. He offered it to Sri Darbar Sahib.

Mala (Necklace)-

These are two necklaces that are very valuable and were offered by a Sikh devotee. Their value is very great, but due to the supreme devotion, they have been given a place in Sri Darbar Sahib.

Maharaja Ranjit Singh's Siri Sahib (Sword)-

The hilt of this beautiful, precious *Siri Sahib* is made of gold, and precious diamonds and pearls are embedded in it.

Necklace of Pure Pearls-

A precious necklace of 108 pure pearls was offered by the Maharaja at a time when he came to Sri Darbar Sahib with offerings, but the person carrying the offerings was late in arriving. So, instead of bowing with empty hands, the Maharaja offered the necklace of pure pearls, which is now adorned in the Tosha Khana.

36. Golden Doors

The four doors of Sri Darbar Sahib are generally made of silver, which are very valuable, but on special days, doors with gold leaf are installed, which are exceedingly beautiful and feature intricate *Meenakari* (enamel work). Later, these doors are taken down and deposited in the Tosha Khana.

The Golden Pair of Doors at the Darshani Deori-

Maharaja Ranjit Singh had offered a pair of golden doors , and three doors were made later. But these doors are only installed on special days and are then taken down and deposited in the Tosha Khana.

Golden Chakkar (Discs)-

On special days, these golden discs are placed in Sri Darbar Sahib. The weight of these discs is 18 *tole*, 8 *mase*, and 6 *rattian*. They are very beautiful.

Nine Chhabbe (Tassels/Pendants)-

There are 9 *chhabbe* with strings of pure and precious pearls, and also ten *mukaishi* (silver-thread) *chhabbe*.

Golden Jhalar (Fringe)-

A very beautifully made fringe, weighing 19 *tole* and 6 *mase*.

Golden Pankhe (Fans)-

Two golden fans with bamboo frames, and golden nails are attached to them for decoration.

Golden Kahian (Hoes)-

There are five golden hoes here, and their handles are made of silver. They were made during the first Kar Seva in 1923.

Chanani (Canopy)-

The Nawab of Hyderabad gave a *Chanani* as a gift to his friend Maharaja Ranjit Singh, which has golden threads, red velvet cloth, and is also decorated with diamonds and pearls. Sometime ago, when its value was assessed by jewelers, its price was estimated at 80 lakh (8 million) rupees. When the Maharaja found it beautiful, instead of using it for himself, he offered it at Sri Darbar Sahib. This *Chanani* was burned during the 1984 Blue Star attack.

Special Sandalwood Chaur (Fly-whisk)-

A special *Chaur* was offered by a Muslim Pir, Haji Muhammad Maskin, in praise, respect, and love for the Guru Sahibs, to the *Raagi* Bhai Hira Singh Ji on

December 31, 1925, upon coming to Sri Amritsar for the Darbar Sahib. It was prepared by him over 5 years and 7 months from 9 *mann* and 14 *ser* of sandalwood, by making fine strands, numbering 85,000. A *diwan* (congregation) was held in front of Sri Akal Takht, and the managers of Sri Harmandir Sahib accepted this *Chaur* from the Pir Ji and, as a mark of respect, offered him 100 mohars (gold coins) and a *shawl*.

37. Silver Kahian (Hoes) and Tasle (Pans)

These special hoes were made for Kar Seva and were used during the Kar Seva of 1973. There are also some silver *tasle* (pans).

Special Khanda (Double-edged sword)-

This is a special *Khanda* which has *Kirpans* (swords) and a *Chakkar* (quoit) on both sides, made of white gold. This service (offering) was made by a devotee from Africa.

Golden Chhatar (Canopy/Chandni)-

This has pure gold frills attached, weighing 20 pounds , and fine diamonds are also embedded in it.

Chhabbe (Tassels/Pendants)-

The number of valuable *chhabbe* is 21.

Dollar- (likely referring to a 'daal' or shield-like ornament)

A special golden *Jhalar* (fringe) made of very beautiful, pure gold.

Golden Chhabba-

The number of this special golden *chhabba* is one.

Golden Ase (Staffs/Maces)-

Their number is five.

Thamm (Pillars)-

Two golden pillars, which are iron rods plated with gold.

Golden Kamanian (Arches)-

A brass frame plated with gold.

Golden Fan Handle

Golden Sehre (Headdresses)

A secret offering was made by a devotee.

Valuable Ring-

The daughter of Maharaja Duleep Singh offered this ring, which is very valuable and has one large diamond and eight small diamonds embedded in it.

Moti Mala (Pearl Necklace)-

This necklace has three strands of diamonds and three of... (cut off), and was offered by some Sikhs from America during their *darshan*.

Valuable diamonds were offered by General Dhanna Singh Malwai-

The above-mentioned items are kept safe in the Tosha Khana, and some are displayed for *darshan* on *Gurpurabs* (festivals), such as the Avtar (birth) of the First Patshahi, Avtar of the Fourth Patshahi, Gurgaddi (succession) of the Sixth Patshah, Avtar of the Tenth

Guru Sahib, and the Prakash Utsav (enshrinement day) of Sri Guru Granth Sahib Ji.

38. False Accusations

Sometimes, when the congregation and devotees feel something is not right, they express their objection and anger. This has been happening since ancient times, and in the time to come, the traditions of Sri Darbar Sahib will continue to be respected. Many such struggles have been seen, and many sacrifices have also been made. At such times, opposing factions make false accusations against the devotees to claim they are right, but in time, this truth eventually comes out. Here, only the truth is respected, and the false accusations are exposed over time. Time certainly gives a reply and punishment to those who make false accusations. It is necessary to read the history of this place, and then you will learn much of the reality - it is necessary for every Sikh to know.

Sacrifices-

The *Amrit* (nectar) water of the Sarovar Sahib at Sri Darbar Sahib, the high sentiments, and the path to liberation are the faith and proof for the congregation. It is a historical fact that those who made great sacrifices took their *darshan*, bathed, and received spiritual strength from here. Bhai Mani Singh Ji, Baba Deep Singh Ji, Baba Jassa Singh Ramgarhia, Jassa Singh Ahluwalia, Bhai Gurbakhsh Singh, Bhai Sukha Singh, Bhai Mehtab Singh, Bhai Satwant Singh, Bhai Beant

Singh... lakhs of warriors took their sentiment from here, made sacrifices, and those who became martyrs manifested in high spirits (Chardi Kala) and will continue to do so.

Value and Worth-

For Sikhs, the value and worth of Sri Darbar Sahib is dearer than their own lives, and to this day, lakhs of Sikhs have performed services and made sacrifices to uphold the honor and glory of Sri Darbar Sahib. Not only Sikhs who come for *darshan*, but devotees of all kinds, sitting far away, are also connected with reverence and sentiment, yearning for it day and night. But *darshan* is only granted to those whom He himself blesses with love and calls. We all need to understand the high value and worth of Sri Darbar Sahib - this is true devotion. May the Guru have mercy on all and bless them with *deedar* (vision), bathing, and bless their lives with a path of nectar.

39. Changes

There is a big difference between the Sri Darbar Sahib and the city of Sri Amritsar Sahib at the time of its *Prakash* (manifestation) and what it is now. It is the Guru's grace that whatever changes are happening and have happened, they are all very good and in high spirits (Chardi Kala). It is all within the Guru's will (Bhana) that attacks happened, gold was applied, warriors made sacrifices, buildings were constructed, gold, diamonds, and pearls were offered, the Darbar

Sahib was decorated, the Sarovar Sahib was made permanent (Pakka), electricity was installed, cameras were installed, sheds were built, and changes in cleaning, security, and accommodation occurred - the Guru Sahib is getting all this done. If anyone says "I am doing it" or "the committee is doing it" - this would not be appropriate. May the Guru Sahib continue to bestow grace.

New Schemes-

As it pleases the Guru Sahib, changes have to be made in the tasks or management at Sri Darbar Sahib - everything happens according to the Guru Sahib's will. Even in earlier times, devotees yearned for *darshan* from hundreds or thousands of kilometers away, and when their prayer was accepted, they received the good fortune of *darshan*. For the high spirits of Sri Darbar Sahib and the convenience of the congregation, the Satguru bestows grace, and various changes are made for facilities. But this is kept in mind: that the Guru Sahib's tasks always remain in high spirits, and any change for the congregation provides facilities while always being merciful. The history up to this day bears witness to this.

Facilities-

In ancient times, the Sri Sarovar Sahib was temporary (Kaccha). Devotees coming for *darshan* from near and far would set up camps in their groups in the *Parkarma*, rest, and stay here for many days performing

various services, or finding a suitable place, would build their *Bungas* (residences) or homes and settle. Here, the congregation, due to the Guru Sahib's rules, would take care, provide facilities to each other, and, understanding it as service, make their lives successful. The managers, from the very beginning, took utmost care of the congregation's facilities. Even the Guru Sahib himself, along with Mata Ji, would prepare *Langar*, provide warm water, and personally provide various facilities for resting. That same rule continues today. Now, there are more facilities than before, and more institutions have opened. The Guru will continue to bestow grace.

40. Other Prominent Gurdwara Sahibs in Sri Amritsar

Along with Sri Darbar Sahib, the holy city here is adorned with numerous Gurdwaras. The true Bani (teachings) that manifests every day from the Gurdwaras built in every village and city of Punjab, and even at wells, fields, and special places, helps in understanding human life and love. Gurdwaras have been built in almost every country of the world, which illuminate Sikhi. And in the time to come, every year, in various countries where one could not even have imagined, beautiful Gurdwaras are being manifested. Today, the total number of Gurdwaras in the world is estimated at... but perhaps their number is much higher than this. In Punjab, there are approximately 13,000

villages. Each village has an average of 2-5 Gurdwaras. Cities have 50-60-100 Gurdwaras. Therefore, 13,000 villages x 3 = 39,000, and including cities and foreign countries, the total number is estimated at.... Lakhs to crores (millions to tens of millions) and even *arbs* (billions) of rupees have been spent on every Gurdwara in foreign countries. Annually, hundreds of Gurdwaras are opening in the country and abroad, especially in foreign countries. Wherever two or four Sikh families come to settle, they wish to build a Gurdwara. The rest is the blessing of Satguru Nanak Dev Ji and Sri Guru Granth Sahib that the world has begun to understand and respect the Sikh religion. The day is not far when the Sikh religion will begin to be understood in the world and will begin to be adopted - the *Nishans* (flags) of the Gurdwaras will be visible from afar.

Martyrdom's Guard-

Sri Harmandir Sahib is the home of praise, the house of God, humanity, religion, love, devotion, penance, liberation, power, and compassion . That is why the voice of truth rises from here, which is not agreeable to sinners. For this reason, from time to time, foreigners have caused damage by attacking it. The Sikhs gave the invaders who came to loot Hindustan a tough fight (made them chew iron grams) and saved Hindustan. You may or may not know, Hindustan was very large before, and it has been broken into 15 pieces so far. The number of attacks on Sri Darbar Sahib is high , and the Sikhs have given a reply to the attackers from time to

time, but they never feared to shed rivers of blood for the land of Sri Darbar Sahib. Every tile and marble is soaked in blood, and any attacker is ultimately destroyed by the divine power, and in the future, if anyone comes with the intent of sacrilege, they have to face defeat. Many years ago, I and two of my friends went to Sri Darbar Sahib, it was perhaps 1986. We had walked only 10-15 meters in the *Parkarma* when someone from behind put a hand on my shoulder and said, "Come, I'll show you the blood". Turning back a little, he showed us blood in various places on the marble slabs. In several places, handprints and footprints were also imprinted. We were astonished and walked on. Then we wondered, "Who was this Singh?" - after two minutes, we tried to find him, but he was not to be found. We did not find those bloodstains again. The rest, God knows. Many other people have seen and believed many things.

41. Karah Prashad

A large amount of *Karah Prashad* is offered at Sri Darbar Sahib. This is a Sikh custom and tradition. This *Prashad* was first prepared and presented by a devotee during the time of Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji; it is possible this tradition may have started from then. This *Prashad* is prepared from wheat flour, and you can get it from the *Karah Prashad* office (room) in the *Parkarma* by offering money (donation) according to your devotion. You can take it in a platter to Sri Darbar Sahib, where your *Prashad* is accepted, and you receive blessings.

The rest, *Prashad* is distributed to everyone outside the gate near the Lachi Beri. Thousands of kilos of *Prashad* are made almost every day.

Routes to reach-

Even the gods and goddesses yearn for the *darshan* of Sri Darbar Sahib, and Akal Purakh (God) himself has come here for *darshan* and service. That is why there is always a huge rush here. The aspirant can come here from anywhere by rail, bus, their own car, or plane. You can have *darshan* by taking a direct flight from many countries to Sri Amritsar, or you can come by air from Delhi, Mumbai, and other airports in the country. There are also good routes for cars, buses, and trains. I think hundreds of buses, 5-7 trains, and 50-70 flights arrive at the beautiful airport here every day. There is no problem regarding coming, going, or staying - routes are established from all over the world.

Security-

The SGPC has its own security forces, which are called the Task Force or *Sevadars*. Their number is around several hundred... who are tasked with the security of Sri Darbar Sahib and protecting it from any rule-breaking or sacrilege. They have traditional weapons and even weapons beyond that, but generally, they are seen holding only *Barchhe* (spears) in their hands. They wear special traditional uniforms or Sikh cultural uniforms. When needed, they are present for all kinds of security.

NRI (Non-Resident Indian)

Every NRI has a great desire for *darshan* and service at Sri Darbar Sahib, and sometimes they first have *darshan* before even going to their homes. It is also special that NRIs offer their *Dasvandh* (tithe) or even more service. Sometimes, many valuable items and large sums of money are offered by NRIs with devotion. In this service, if seen from an economic, financial perspective, it amounts to a very large sum. It's not just devotees of Punjabi origin; lakhs of devotees from other religions, cultures, and faiths from abroad offer valuable items and financial sums with their devotion. There are also lakhs of such devotees here who perform great service without revealing their names. This work will continue forever. NRIs have many sentiments of devotion, and they yearn to the point of sacrificing themselves for Sri Darbar Sahib.

42. The Granthi Sahibs of Sri Harmandir Sahib

Since the *Prakash* (manifestation) of Sri Darbar Sahib, at first, it was the *darshan* of the Guru Sahib. But then, on August 30, 1604, the Sri Guru Adi Granth Sahib was enshrined (Prakash). At Sri Darbar Sahib, the *Dhur Ki Bani* (Bani from the source) was manifested not just for the Sikhs but for the world. Here, Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji appointed Baba Buddha Ji as the first Granthi of Sri Darbar Sahib. It is important to note here that the Granthi Sahib has a special attire and rules. Now, it is

necessary for the Granthi to be *Amritdhari* (initiated). When Baba Buddha Ji went with the congregation to Gwalior, performing *Chauki* (procession) with Kirtan for Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib, he entrusted the service of Granthi to his cousin, Bhai Piara Singh. This family continued to perform the service until the arrival of Bhai Mani Singh, and then Bhai Mani Singh became the head Granthi, and the descendants of Bhai Piara were appointed as *Ardasie* (those who perform the Ardas). According to some sources, there is also mention of Baba Ji's younger son, Baba Bhana Ji, being the head *Sevadar* (volunteer). When Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib went to live in Kiratpur, the son of Prithi Chand (Meherban), fulfilling his own desire with the help of the government, took control of Sri Darbar Sahib. After Meherban's death, his son Hari Ji became the owner of his *gaddi* (seat), took the management into his hands, and when Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Sahib Ji came for *darshan* after his manifestation, Hari Ji and his *Masands* (agents) closed the doors of the Darshani Deori. During this time, they maintained control for 62 years and committed acts of self-will (*Manmatian*). After Hari Ji's death, due to a family feud, the three brothers left Sri Darbar Sahib. At this time, Sri Guru Gobind Singh Ji sent Bhai Mani Singh Ji to establish good management, making him the head Granthi. Five other *Amritdhari* Singhs were also sent with him. You can read a separate page about Bhai Mani Singh. Bhai Mani Singh Ji used to go for *darshan* at Sri Anandpur Sahib from time to

time. During his service at Sri Darbar Sahib, after the martyrdom of Bhai Mani Singh, the Turks looted Sri Amritsar and took control. They desecrated the Darbar Sahib. Zakariya Khan had Massa Ranghar commit the sacrilege. But Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh took revenge by hanging his head on a spear, and the Turks remained in control for 13 years. Now, the Singhs liberated it and celebrated Vaisakhi - the Dal Khalsa took control. Sri Darbar Sahib had been destroyed. Jathedar Jassa Singh Ahluwalia, at that time, collected a fund of seven lakhs and had the current Darbar Sahib rebuilt by Bhai Des Raj of Sur Singh. In these circumstances, when the *Maryada* (code of conduct) was broken and sacrilege occurred, religious ceremonies were not allowed here. After Bhai Mani Singh, there is mention of Bhai Gopal Das Udasi becoming the head Granthi. He would take his expenses from the offerings and serve the rest in the *Langar* or distribute it among the poor and needy. A time came when Gopal Das Ji was accused of using the money for his own purposes, and the Panth leaders passed a resolution to remove him and appointed Bhai Chanchal Singh as the head Granthi. Then, Bhai Chanchal Singh's servant, Atma Singh Ji, was appointed. With the arrival of the British government, some changes came in policy. Now, the management began to run like that of the *Mahants*. Bhai Shyam Singh, Bhai Makhan Singh Ji, Bhai Jassa Singh, Bhai Jawahar Singh, Bhai Harnam Singh, Bhai Fateh Singh,

Bhai Kartar Singh, Bhai Labh Singh Ji, Bhai Thakur Singh Ji, Mahant Mool Singh, Bhai Achhar Singh, Bhai Bhupinder Singh, Bhai Arjan Singh, Giani Chet Singh, Bhai Kirpal Singh, and so on, the tradition continues.

43. The History of the Bungas

As Sri Harmandir Sahib is dearer to the Sikhs than life, and the Sarovar is the pool of nectar, the Mughals and plunderers kept an eye on destroying it to extinguish the sentiments of the Sikhs. But today, this Harmandir Sahib is known among the special holy places of the world . Sikhs have faced very bad times because they fight not only for their own rights, truth, and justice but also embrace strangers and get martyred. Sri Darbar Sahib is the 'Mecca' of the Sikhs, and to maintain its glory, lakhs of Sikhs have been martyred and are ready to be martyred. The governments of the time, after understanding its history and sentiments, destroyed it, but the Sikhs have always waged war against those who desecrated its glory and sent them to hell.

As time passed and circumstances allowed, Sikh Jathedars, Sardars, and warriors, expressing their devotion to Sri Harmandir Sahib, built their *Bungas* (residences, mansions, forts) nearby. The sentiment was great devotion, protection, preaching, not being able to live far away, sentiment, love... because of which, from time to time, numerous *Bungas* were built, and they did not let any shortcoming come in fulfilling their duty and devotion to Sri Darbar Sahib. These *Bungas*,

which were once the *Bungas* of generals and Sardars, were faded by time, and many were also destroyed by plunderers. Very few among the congregation have information about them. Even today, during excavation, *Bungas* made of small bricks are visible under the ground, but the administration is not serious about their preservation.

A brief description of a few *Bungas* is as follows- Bunga Akhara Brahm Buta, Ram Singh Gyani, Ramgarhia, Buriewale Sardar, Jaitu Walian Majbi Singhan, Bhai Vasti Ram, Jwala Singh, Sant Joga Singh, Tek Singh Wala, Sardar Sohla Walie, Budh Singh Wala, Sohia Wala, Shaheed Bunga, Kesgarhia, Anandpuria, Dasaunda Singh, Jhabalia, Kalia Wale Sardar, Tara Singh, Kahan Singh Maan, Bhanga Singh Thanesar, Majja Singh, Baghel Singh, Mira Kotia, Sham Singh Attari, Jassa Singh Nirmala, Lakkha Singh Nirmala, Charat Singh Raagi, Jodh Singh Sauria, Jwala Singh Padhania, Kabule Walian, Jallian Wala, Shahbadian, Majithia, Singhpuria, Singhpuria II, Gudde Walian, Ghaneyya Sardaran, Raja Dhian Singh, Baran Dali, Akal Bunga, Jodh Singh Chhapawala, Deva Singh Shaheed, Raagi Dhanpat Singh, Jarnail Maha Singh, Bhai Gurdas, Abhai Singh Hukamnamian, Nakai Sardaran Wala, Barki Wala, Gharialian Wala, Jhanda, Khadoorian, Sialkotian, Goindwalian, Chiche Wale Sardaran, Shukar Chakkia Sardaran, Ghanta Ghar, Sodhian Anandpuria, Kahan Singh Nirmal, Kahan Singh, Noor Mahlia, Ahluwalia, Malwaia, Bhai Sahiban, Sardar Jale Walia, etc., were

Bungas, but now many of these are no longer in existence; they have been buried or destroyed. There is a need to understand the sentiment of these *Bungas*, and a great need for their service and preservation - there is a special need to preserve history. I hold good hope. Thank you.

44. Some details about Baba Buddha Sahib

Baba Buddha Ji has a very big role and service in the Sikh nation, and Baba Ji, who had the invaluable *darshan* of the first six Guru Sahibs, is a very fortunate and precious Sikh. Any praise for his personality is less, but still, it is necessary to write something about Baba Ji in this book, otherwise, the book would not be complete. Let us come together to receive the blessings of Baba Buddha Ji. Among the Chandravanshi Kshatriyas, in the Yaduvanshi Rajputs, Jaisal Bhatti was a great warrior who founded the city of Jaisalmer in 1213 Bikrami, which remained the capital of Rajputana. His son was Hem, who was also known by the names Hem Hel or Bhim. Hem's son Jodhraj (Jandhur) had 12 sons, and one son's name was Papat, and his son was Randhawa, who was said to be a great warrior, but then he became famous as Randhawa. His family came and settled near Bikaner, Punjab, the Ravi river, and the Beas river, and they also founded the city of Batala. In 1272 Bikrami, they also founded the city of Chavinda. As this lineage moved forward, the next great men in the Randhawa lineage were Band Ji, Kajjal Ji, Bhoa Ji, Aughar Ji, Dhaula Ji, Karan, Kathu, Mall, Dalla Ji, Gaggo,

Bua, Sugha Ji, and Sugha Ji's son was Baba Buddha Ji. He was born to father Sugha Randhawa and mother Gauran on 7 Katak Vadi Das, Friday, Sammat 1563 Bikrami, in the village of Kathu Nangal, district Sri Amritsar Sahib, and his first name was Bura. From childhood, he would graze cattle and then, making a hut near the Ravi, Bura began to live with the cattle. It was here he met Satguru Nanak Ji, offered him milk, and at a young age, spoke very wise words, which is why the Guru Ji gave him the name Baba Buddha, and he became such a Sikh of the Guru Sahib that, by the Guru's grace, he became an ocean of Gurbani's knowledge. At the age of 20, in 1583 Bikrami, he was married to Mata Miroya, the daughter of the Samrah got (clan) from Achal (Batala) village, with whom he had sons Bhai Sudhari, Bhai Bhikhari, Bhai Mehmu Ji, and Bhai Bhana Ji. He received the blessing of applying the Gurgaddi *Tilak* (anointing mark) for the second, third, fourth, fifth, and up to the sixth Guru. He was so strong that he never tired of service, and so learned that he continued to perform great service and deeds related to Gurbani. He laid the foundation stones of many towns, built temples and dharamsalas (rest houses) for the Guru's house. He struck the first *Takk* (dig) for the Bauli Sahib with 84 steps at Goindwal. On his advice, Guru Amar Das Ji established 22 *Manjis* (preaching centers), of which he was the head. His blessing is immense in the construction and service related to Sri Amritsar. He himself continued to carry the basket and

look after the Guru's fields. He offered the Ardas (prayer) and laid the foundation of Sri Darbar Sahib on 1 Magh 1645 Bikrami. The birth of Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib happened after receiving a boon from him. His advice was also sought on the *Bir* (volume) Sahib, he became the first Granthi, and he had a prominent role in the creation of Sri Akal Takht. He started the *Shabad Chauki* (musical procession). Finally, on 14 Maghar Sudi 4, Sammat 1688, at the age of 125, placing his son Bhai Bhana Ji's arm in the hand of Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib, he merged with the Divine Light (passed away) at village Ramdas, district Amritsar. The Guru Sahib gave his shoulder to the bier. A Gurdwara Sahib is established there, and he holds a very high place among Sikhs even today. Blessed is Baba Buddha Ji.

45. **Chiku and Mikhu**

The excavation of Sri Sarovar Sahib at Sri Darbar Sahib was for Kar Seva. The congregation was arriving in huge numbers from far and wide. From the early morning (*Amrit Vela*), the congregation would get busy. Under the supervision of the Guru Sahib, Sikhs who were always present in service, like Baba Buddha Ji and Bhai Gurdas Ji, would carry baskets, some would fill them, and some would gather the earth. Some Sikhs misbehaved with two Sikhs due to their low caste and even went and told the Guru Sahib to remove them from here as they were of a low caste. The Guru Sahib explained to them, but they did not understand. The Guru Sahib put the Sikhs Chiku and Mikhu to service a

little distance away. The service continued, but after a short time, the bodies of the high-caste (Sikhs), who were in large numbers, began to itch. They began to writhe from the itch. Finally, the itch worsened, and they ran screaming to the Guru Sahib. The itch kept increasing - the Guru Sahib said that only those who embrace Bhai Chiku and Mikhu could be cured. At first, no one would go, thinking they would be polluted, but due to the itching, whoever went and hugged them was cured. When they understood, they asked for forgiveness from the Guru Sahib and from Chiku and Mikhu. We are all of the human caste. Do not discriminate based on caste.

Bibi from Kabul-

Kar Seva was ongoing; the congregation was making their lives successful by performing service. The congregation noticed that a woman carrying a basket would often wave her hand in the air. Seeing her do this repeatedly, the matter reached the Guru Sahib. The Guru Sahib came to the woman and asked the reason for her waving her hand in front of the congregation. The woman explained that she was a resident of Kabul. Her elderly father-in-law had received Sikhi from the time of Sri Guru Nanak Dev, and the whole family loved the Guru Sahib very much . "In the early morning, after finishing my work, I put my 5-7 month-old baby in a sling, leave her at home, meditate on the Guru Sahib, close my eyes, and pray. When I open my eyes, I reach Amritsar from Kabul . When the baby cries, I give the

sling a push from here, and she becomes quiet." The congregation was astonished to hear this. In the evening, she would pray again and reach Kabul. This happens only by the Guru's grace - it is a very big thing - this is love.

46. Where is the first Sri Adi Granth Sahib now?

This chapter is the most difficult to write, but it is the praise of the Guru Sahib; he himself will graciously get this work completed. Come, let's leave it, O Jaikara (victory cry), let's start the topic. Praise for Akal Purakh (God) has been happening on earth since before Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji. Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji graciously started such a path that today the whole world knows as the Sikh religion. A great soul was given the responsibility for this work and task, and he was Satguru Nanak. "Satguru Nanak manifested, the fog cleared, and light shone." Everyone recognizes the Guru as the light of the world. The Guru Ji uttered the *Dhur Ki Bani* (Bani from the source) and, while he continued to compile it in the form of a *Pothi* (volume), other saints, great souls, and the succeeding Guru Sahibs also bestowed this same grace. The journey reached Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, and the Guru Sahib, to fulfill a very grand vision, necessity, and mission, and to remove the darkness of ignorance from the world, decided to compose the Sri Guru Granth Sahib. An announcement was made that whoever possessed the *Pothis* of the Guru Sahibs and other collected Bani

should bring it to us. It was going to take a lot of time - the task was enormous. The work of settling Sri Amritsar Sahib had already begun. The Guru Sahib started the great work. Along with the collected Bani, other Bani also began to arrive. The Guru Sahib sat under a Beri tree and entrusted the great service to Bhai Gurdas Ji. Along with him, the Guru Sahib also blessed four other Sikhs, among whom were Bhai Sant Ram, Bhai Haria Ji, Bhai Sukha Ji, and Bhai Mansa Ram (Note: It is possible that some scholars may have other names - please forgive me), who also joined the service as assistant scribes. Whatever Bani came, these four would transcribe it and submit it to the Sri Guru Sahib, and only the *Dhur Ki Bani* would the Guru Sahib order Bhai Gurdas Ji to include . The Guru Sahib knew everything about which was the *Amrit Bani* (nectar-like Bani). Meanwhile, the Guru Sahib's brother, Prithi Chand, and his son, Meherban, presented a large Granth named "Pran Sangli," claiming it contained the Bani uttered by Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji during his visit to Sangladeep (Sri Lanka). But Sri Guru Arjan Dev, after reading this Granth, said it did not meet the touchstone of *Dhur Ki Bani* and refused to include it in the Sri Adi Granth Sahib. Prithi Chand and Meherban were angered by this, but the Guru Sahib did not accept anyone's influence. Meanwhile, three scholars, Sri Kana, Peelu, and Chhajju, also arrived with their compositions. But the Guru Sahib refused them, as their Bani was not in accordance with *Dhur Ki Bani*. In addition to this,

requests also came from the Emperor and several Qazis (judges), and there was even pressure and coercion to include other Bani, but the Guru Sahib only included the Bani of truth.

47. Where is the first Sri Adi Granth Sahib now? - 2

The Guru Sahib had thought of starting this work in 1599, and in 1601, the holy work was commenced. It was bound to take a lot of effort and time to complete, but now its complete scribes were 36, among whom were six Guru Sahibs, 15 Bhagats (saints), 11 Bhatts (bards), and four Gursikhs. At last, this great work was completed in four years, and the Guru Sahib sent Bhai Banno Ji to Lahore to get it bound. Bhai Banno's village was Mangat. Bhai Banno Ji went to his village and to Lahore for this work, and during this time, he made another copy of this Granth. After getting the binding work done, when the Guru Sahib saw the Granth Bhai Banno had, he saw that it contained some other Bani. Instead of it, he enshrined (Prakash) the Adi Sri Granth Sahib written by Bhai Gurdas Ji at Sri Darbar and appointed Baba Buddha Ji as the first Granthi Sahib. Now, as the Granth Sahib by Bhai Gurdas Ji was kept at the Darbar Sahib day and night, copying of the second Granth Sahib began, which came to be known by the name 'Banno Wali Bir' (Banno's volume). Sometimes this *Bir* was also called 'Khari Bir' (the brackish/rejected volume), and more copies were made. The first *Bir* was

enshrined (Prakash), and a *Hukamnama* (edict) was taken. At that time, *Hukamnama* was also called *Awaja* (voice). "The Lord Himself has stood to resolve the affairs of the Saints; He has come to get the work done, O Ram." This work, the first *Prakash*, happened in 1604; Baba Buddha Ji was the first Granthi. Time passed, and after 2 years, Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji was martyred. Now, the Sixth Patshah began to bless the congregation, but in 1634, he went from Sri Amritsar Sahib to Kartarpur Sahib and took this *Bir* with him. After this, in 1635, the Guru Ji went from Sri Kartarpur Sahib to Kiratpur Sahib. The rest of the family was also here, and the Guru Ji's eldest son, Baba Gurditta Ji's eldest son, Baba Dhir Mal, used to think that he would get the Guruship, which is why he always maintained this sentiment. The Guru Sahib then went from there to Sri Kiratpur Sahib, but Dhir Mal kept the *Bir* with him and began to make the congregation feel, and started to act like a Guru, showing that the *Bir* was with him. Meanwhile, Dhir Mal's father, Baba Gurditta Ji, passed away at Kiratpur, but Dhir Mal did not even go for the final rites because he feared someone might take the *Bir* in his absence. In time, the Sixth Patshah merged with the Divine Light (passed away), but Dhir Mal received a shock when the Guru Sahib entrusted the Guruship to his younger brother, Sri Har Rai Ji. Dhir Mal was now very angry and disappointed. He would always think of seizing the Guruship and held his court at Kartarpur Sahib.

48. Where is the first Sri Adi Granth Sahib now? - 3

In time, Sri Guru Har Rai Ji entrusted the *gaddi* (seat) to his son, Baba Sri Har Krishan Ji, and Dhir Mal's hopes were dashed again. Sri Har Krishan Ji merged with the Divine Light at a young age. Now, as the next Guru Sahib was not announced, there was no one to challenge Dhir Mal. The Guru Sahibs used to entrust the next authority, but this time, as no announcement was made, Dhir Mal's 20-25 year period seemed to have become successful. The congregation began to consider him the Guru and come for his *darshan*, and offerings and donations also began to come in heaps. Meanwhile, the congregation also found out that the Eighth Guru Sahib had not mentioned the name of the next Guru, but had said, "Baba Bakale" (The Baba is at Bakala). Now, 22 people set up their *gaddis* (seats) at Baba Bakala, among whom Dhir Mal, because of the *Bir*, considered himself the most entitled and held the most influence. By the Guru's grace, Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji was revealed as the Guru form by Bhai Makhan Shah Lubana, and now Dhir Mal's hopes were dashed again. He had his rogue, Shihans, fire a shot at Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji, and they looted his belongings. When Bhai Makhan Shah Lubana found out about this incident, he, along with his men, went and thrashed Dhir Mal soundly, retrieved the looted belongings, and the *Bir* Sahib also came to the Guru Sahib. The Guru Sahib ordered the congregation to return the *Bir* and, after a

short time, left Baba Bakala for preaching. This incident is from 1664. The Guru Sahib comes to Sri Kiratpur and then buys the mound of Makhewal nearby and founds the village Chak Nanaki in his mother's name, which is famous today as Sri Anandpur Sahib. After about ten years, the Guru Sahib was martyred in Delhi, and then in 1676, Aurangzeb arrested Dhir Mal, and in 1677, he died in prison. In 1678, Dhir Mal's elder son, Ram Chand, was killed in Delhi. At this time, the *Bir* Sahib was with Dhir Mal's younger son, Pahar Mal. This Pahar Mal eventually returned to Sri Kartarpur. The *Bir* was with him. According to some history, Abdali's sons, Taimur and Jahan Khan, along with their Faujdar (governor) of Jalandhar, Nasir Ali, caused destruction at Kartarpur, and the *Bir* Sahib was burnt in the fire. Some information suggests this *Bir* was not burnt and is still with the descendants today. As soon as time permitted, Jathedar Jassa Singh Ahluwalia went to punish Nasir. When they learned he was dead, the Singhs went to his grave, exhumed his skeleton, and burned it to take revenge. Note- If anyone else has more information, please preach it. The SGPC should register the history. Forgiveness for any mistakes. Instead of creating useless issues and spectacles, please obtain the Guru's blessings by preaching.

49. In 1579, Baba Sri Chand also came to see Sri Guru Ram Das Ji

In the year 1579, Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji's son, Baba Sri Chand Ji, came here, and during his *darshan* of Sri Guru Ram Das Ji, Sri Guru Ram Das Ji wiped Baba Ji's feet with his holy beard. Baba Ji then embraced the Guru Ji and gave him blessings and expressed happiness and good wishes for the future tasks and works. The Guru Sahib served Baba Ji very well.

Various Names-

Sri Amritsar Sahib has had several different names to this day. When the order was given according to Sri Guru Amar Das Ji's command to establish the city, its name was Guru Da Chak, Guru Ke Mahal, Ramdas Pur, and finally, it is now famous throughout the world as Sri Amritsar Sahib, and almost everyone knows it because of Sri Darbar Sahib.

The Sentiment of the Four Doors-

The four doors have a grand sentiment, according to which anyone from the four directions, meaning from all sides, who abides by the rules, can come . Those who come here are not just Sikhs; people of every religion, color, caste, rich, poor, black, white, man, woman - anyone can come. There are many religions or places in the world where women are not allowed to go or other religions are not welcomed, but here, everyone is welcomed....

Gold-

The gold applied here was a service done by the Sikh King, Maharaja Ranjit Singh Ji, and other devotees, a description of which you can read in a larger form in the book. But even today, knowing gold is a precious metal, lakhs of devotees continue to perform the service of (offering) gold here. Besides this, even today, gold ornaments, pots, and other things are offered with devotion by devotees. Their value is in *arbs* and *kharbs* (billions and trillions).

Religious sentiment in the Maharaja's heart-

Maharaja Ranjit Singh, despite being a king, was so religious that he would start his day only after having *darshan* of the Sri Guru Granth Sahib and listening to the *Path* (recitation) every day. He respected the Sri Guru Granth Sahib Ji more than his own life and also respected other religions. Every good, heart-pleasing, beautiful item he would buy and offer in service to the Darbar Sahib. With this sentiment, he had vast properties registered in the name of the Gurdwaras. He always bowed his head before the *Hukamnama* (edict).

50. Festivals

At Sri Darbar Sahib, Gurbani has been leaving its impact and bestowing grace for centuries, but special festivals are celebrated here. These festivals are related to the *Prakash* (birth) and *Jyoti Jot Samana* (merging with the divine light) of the Guru Sahibs, but here, the festival of Diwali is celebrated with great beauty. To see the Diwali here, the congregation comes from near and

far, and even from foreign countries. Crores (tens of millions) of rupees are spent on flower strings to enhance the beauty. It looks like a different world.

Diwali, Bandi Chhor-

Related to Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib Ji, the True King, who, upon his release from Gwalior Fort, brought 52 kings with him to freedom and reached Sri Darbar Sahib. In happiness at his return and his gracing his throne at Sri Akal Takht again, the congregation celebrated and welcomed him by lighting *ghee* (clarified butter) lamps on the paths and at Sri Darbar Sahib. That day was Diwali. For this reason, to this day, lakhs of Sikh devotees go there to celebrate this festival every year, and a special fireworks display is also held. People say, "Food from one's own home, Diwali from Amritsar."

Gurpurab-

Some Guru Sahibs' *Prakash Divas* (birth anniversaries) and *Gurgaddi* (succession) days, Vaisakhi, the *Prakash Divas* of Sri Guru Granth Sahib, and *Gurpurabs* are celebrated with great pomp and show, a tradition that has been going on for a long time. This increases the happiness and devotion within the congregation, and high spirits (Chardi Kala) are built. At Sri Darbar Sahib, not only Sikhs but people from every corner of the world celebrate *Gurpurab* with great devotion and receive the Guru Sahib's blessings.

Prakash Divas (Birth Anniversaries) etc.-

The tradition of celebrating some *Prakash Utsavs* (birth festivals) has been ongoing for centuries. In general, the Sikhs' Guru *Prakash Utsavs*, *Jyoti Jot Samana* (passing), *Gurgaddi*, the *Gurta Gaddi Divas* (Guruship day) of Sri Guru Granth Sahib, Vaisakhi, Diwali, New Year, etc., are celebrated with great pomp by the congregation, and the very large numbers remain a symbol of high spirits.

51. Light

The beautiful building of Sri Darbar Sahib was ready, and its *Prakash* (illumination/manifestation) as a building began to be known in all four corners of the world. The surrounding congregation started to set up camps to enjoy the bliss, and many, to increase this, began to make their residences here as well. As evening fell and it grew dark, there was a need for light. In those times, there was no solar power or electricity. For light, the congregation would produce light by making torches (*Mishala*). Devotees who had set up camps in the surroundings would be blessed by burning wood. At first, light was only provided by torches.

Diyas (Oil Lamps)-

The custom of *diyas* has also been ongoing for a long time. Inside Sri Darbar Sahib, when the Maharaj Ji's *Prakash* (enshrinement) happened in the early morning, light was needed. Therefore, the atmosphere inside was lit with the light of *diyas*. Oil *diyas* produce smoke, but *ghee* (clarified butter) *diyas* do not emit

black smoke. Therefore, light was made by lighting earthen *diyas* to help in the task of *Path* (recitation) inside and for the congregation to have *darshan*. There were also large *diyas* that did not require *ghee* to be added repeatedly.

Candles-

Diyas were kept in *Aale* (niches). Even today, niches for keeping *diyas* can be seen in old buildings. As time passed, after a long time, when candles were developed, light began to be produced with the help of candles alongside torches and *diyas*. Candles were quite successful, and their smoke is generally nominal. Thick candles and wax tapers maintain considerable light for a long time, and various fragrances also began to be added to them, which also produced nice, pure scents.

Lights-

Electricity was brought here by installing poles at Sri Darbar Sahib, but this was met with considerable opposition. As people understood, the opposition decreased, and 8 poles were installed in the *Parkarma*, which brought light to the *Parkarma* and provided great convenience to the congregation. The congregation did not agree to electricity inside for a long time, but finally, the Guru's grace was bestowed, and lights were installed inside as well. With this, the light increased all around, and the beauty also appeared enhanced.

52. Decisions of the Sangat

From time to time, (Sri Darbar Sahib) is used to create an impact. It is not religious people but political people who do this; the congregation knows this. Religious people oppose this, but those in power generally do not let anyone stand in their way. Political people often fire a gun from the shoulder of Sri Darbar Sahib, and the target they want to hit, that target one day riddles their own chest. It is best that the importance of the *Sangat's* (congregation's) decision is always revealed by Akal Purakh Sahib (God) at the right time. The managers manage, but those decisions that have political influence and self-interest are not acceptable to the Guru; the decisions of the *Sangat* are acceptable to the Guru.

Decisions of the Committees-

Committees are formed, and they, on their part, try to make good arrangements for the management. In this, generally, people with a religious bent, considering this holy place as the house of God, always maintain respect and strive for every true service. It is a glorious history, but still, those hungry for political power use everyone, their own and others, everywhere, and they use Sri Darbar Sahib without caring for the rules. Their end is very bad, and they find no refuge in the court of God. In the future, if any management breaks the rules due to the force of power, nothing is hidden from the Guru Sahib.

Doctrinal Decisions-

When religion or the state is (based on) the blessings of the Guru Sahib, the sacrifices of warriors, and the rule of true love, then doctrinal decisions are made. But when political influence increases, political people give priority to their *Kursi* (seat of power) - for them, even God remains just a thing to be used . Time has done much to Sri Darbar Sahib, but still, the Guru Sahib's doctrinal decisions and rules have always been valued. Whatever tasks and mercies religion can do to move the world in high spirits (Chardi Kala), politics cannot. Maharaja Ranjit Singh ruled, but he moved forward in every task keeping the Guru Sahib's rules paramount, gained victories, and established the Sikh Raj. Doctrinal decisions are the rule of Sri Darbar Sahib - no one can challenge this.

53. Kar Seva

The plunderers' belief and thought regarding Sri Harmandir Sahib was that this is the 'Mecca' of the Sikhs, and it is from here that the Sikhs draw power to fight and inflict heavy losses on them. This was true, and it is true today. For this reason, the policy of destroying Sri Harmandir Sahib has been ongoing from time to time. The Sikhs' struggle began against the Mughals and Afghans, and they (the plunderers) committed the act of desecrating the Sikhs' 'Mecca' not just once, but many times. After the sacrilege and desecration, the Sikhs, taking revenge, first performed

Kar Seva in 1746 AD after Lakhpat Rai committed the sin of desecrating Sri Darbar Sahib. After this, Taimur damaged and desecrated the Darbar Sahib, and when time passed, the Sikhs again liberated the Darbar Sahib and performed Kar Seva.

After this, in 1762 AD, Ahmad Shah Abdali blew up Sri Darbar Sahib with cannons, but the Sikhs again took care of Sri Darbar Sahib, performed Kar Seva, and the new building was constructed under the leadership of Jathedar Jassa Singh Ramgarhia by Bhai Des Raj, which is the new building seen today. This construction manifested in 1776 AD, and Maharaja Ranjit Singh put in his full effort and performed every service to keep Sri Darbar Sahib in high spirits. In 1842 AD, Maharaja Sher Singh had it (Kar Seva) done. Then came the British rule and the control of the *Mahants*, and they committed many acts of self-will (Manmatian). Because of this, the Sikh nation again liberated Sri Darbar Sahib.

At this time, the first Kar Seva was held in 1923, and on June 17, 1923, it was initiated by the *Panj Piare* (Five Beloved Ones) - Sant Sham Singh, Sardar Mehtab Singh, Bhai Teja Singh, Bhai Pritam Singh Sodhi, and Bhai Sahib Singh - with golden hoes and silver pans. After this, on March 31, 1973, the *Panj Piare* were Sant Baba Jivan Singh, Sant Baba Kharak Singh, Sant Baba Gurmukh Singh, Sant Baba Seva Singh, and Sant Baba Mohinder Singh. After the 1984 attack, on October 12, 1984, the *Panj Piare* were Sant Baba Harbans Singh,

Sant Baba Daya Singh, Sant Baba Kartar Singh, Sant Baba Diwan Singh, and Sant Baba Darshan Singh.

Note- The meaning of Kar Seva is: to reflect on the sacrileges, destruction, and sanctity of the past and to re-establish the traditions by restoring the building as it was before. During this time, the entire water of the Sri Sarovar Sahib is drained, and the silt is removed from within. If any repair of the walls or bricks is needed, it is completed. If any other improvement is needed, it is done while keeping the rules in mind. Besides this, sometimes other construction, painting, or repairs are also given the name of Kar Seva. This connects the sentiments of the congregation more than usual, and they present themselves with body, mind, and wealth to join the service in massive numbers. To this day, many Chief Ministers of Punjab have themselves performed service by carrying a basket or *Luhaanda* (mortar) on their heads, and the congregation takes the water and holy soil from there to their homes, considering it priceless, and purifies their bodies by rubbing it on themselves.

54. Water Management

First, the Sarovar Sahib was filled by collecting rainwater, and as needed, water was also filled using *Halts* (water wheels). Sometimes, due to lack of water, the Sarovar also dried up, and this worried the managers. So, the *Sevadars* (volunteers) of the time—Sardars, Jathedars, and managers—arranged for

Hanslis (small canals) by digging them from the Ravi river, and from 1785 AD, the water management improved. Farmers with adjacent fields also began to use the water from these *Hanslis* for their work. Then, Baba Kharak Singh, Baba Darshan Singh, and prominent Saints and managers, along with the congregation and administration of the area, covered and preserved the *Hanslis* from above. Engineers made various arrangements to ensure the maximum amount of clean water reached the Sarovars, and special actions and inspections by engineers are always ongoing. The water that reaches here is holy and, by the Guru Sahib's grace, becomes *Amrit* (nectar), which is yearned for by gods, goddesses, warriors, and saints.

Painting (Chitra Kala)-

A visitor is astonished to see the painting/art at Sri Darbar Sahib. This art existed from the very beginning, but it is possible that it was damaged during the times of sacrilege. But when the time came again, the managers would call special artisans and, to this day, continue to get work done as needed. This art is seen on the walls, on the inside of the ceilings, and in some places on the floors. The custom of painting, in ancient times, was to make paintings in praise of kings, and they were made in special places. In the same way, this work also began among the Sikhs. Even today, paintings of the Guru Sahibs from ancient times... and for a long time, floral patterns and paintings of the Guru Sahib, commonly Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji, have also been

seen inside the Sri Guru Granth Sahib. Paintings on walls, ceilings, and niches from ancient times are still visible, and among these, there is also art made of gold, marble, and metals. In many of these, Gurbani or praise of the Guru Sahib is seen written. In the paintings, along with the Guru Sahibs, history, warriors, and saints, there are also vines, plants, flowers, fish, cranes, tortoises, deer, sparrows, peacocks, *Chakki Rahas* (a bird), *Chikors* (partridge), lions, elephants, crocodiles, goats, meditating Sadhus, etc., and many other different types of paintings using various special colors, gold, silver, diamonds, special materials, inks, and various stones and metals. Generally, touching these paintings is prohibited, but due to the touch of the congregation, or due to weather or some other reasons, the art gets affected, for which the managers get Kar Seva done. Some of this artwork is very expensive to create, and only special people can do this work - it is not within everyone's capacity, and the material is also very special. The art at Sri Darbar Sahib is very beautiful - it is priceless - it is in great need of respect and preservation.

55. **Broadcast**

When Sri Darbar Sahib was established (Prakash), Kirtan had already been started by Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji himself. The musical instruments of the Guru Sahibs who performed Kirtan are preserved at Sri Darbar Sahib and at some other holy places. Before this, all 36 (all) of the Satgurus within the Sri Guru Granth Sahib used to

perform Kirtan themselves. After the *Prakash* (enshrinement) of the Sri Guru Granth Sahib, the Guru Sahib and *Kirtaniye* (singers) would perform Kirtan, and earlier, *Katha* (discourse) was also held. At that time, there were no microphones or speakers, and good and bad times came; Kirtan was disrupted. Sacrilege occurred, and the *Maryada* (code of conduct) was broken. At that time, the sound of Kirtan could not be heard far outside, but then these *Raagis* (hymn-singers) and *Dhadis* (bards) were themselves so powerful that their voices would reach quite far, which is not possible today.

Time went on, and finally, the custom of speakers began, and the melodies of Kirtan were heard far outside; the congregation could sit in the *Parkarma* or related places and listen to Kirtan. As time passed, talk of broadcasting began. When no result came from the government or administration, in 1977, I was in Germany at the time. Someone there showed me a Sikh youth, Dr. Jagdish Singh Chauhan, who was in exile in England at the time. He, along with this youth, had installed a device at Sri Darbar Sahib with which the Kirtan broadcast could be heard outside, but this was then stopped, and Dr. Sahib returned to England. They kept trying again, but the managers then started this broadcast only in the early morning and evening for a short time each day.

Finally, as technology improved, this facility increased, and eventually, it began to be broadcast on

TV as well. Now, this broadcast runs all day from *Prakash* (enshrinement) all day at Sri Darbar Sahib and also at several other Gurdwara Sahibs - this is a very good initiative. Previously, some company used to do this broadcast on contract, but now the SGPC is close to achieving success in managing its own arrangement. Seeing the very well-managed arrangement, a devotee sitting far away can also watch the *darshan* of Sri Darbar Sahib at home or even on their phone. In 1984, the *Maryada* was broken, but Giani Zail Singh, who was the President, worried about managing several arrangements. Some controversies also arose regarding this TV broadcast, and it was also seen from a commercial angle, but the devotion of the congregation is that this should only be done according to religious sentiment. It is hoped that in the time to come, the world's best arrangements will be successful.

56. No one can copy

No one can make a copy of Sri Darbar Sahib now, meaning it is forbidden to build a building like Sri Darbar Sahib. Some people did this copy work, but they were not successful. Some obstacle or another arose, and the work was not completed. Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji's brother, Baba Prithi Chand, also tried to copy it, but he too was not successful. Everyone needs to respect this rule or sentiment. A *Shabad* (hymn) is also inscribed in Gurbani: "I have seen all the places, but

none like you.". This holy house of God will always remain in high spirits (Chardi Kala).

Electricity Arrangement-

In the beginning, light inside was provided by *diyas* (lamps) and torches, and the congregation was happy with it. Then, light continued with candles, large *diyas*, and special torches. The era moved forward, and after the birth of electricity, talk began of arranging for electricity here. On January 26, 1896, Sardar Sundar Singh Majithia presented a resolution requesting the installation of electricity. But some managers, Granthi Sahibs, members, and dignitaries began to oppose this scheme. These people considered it a sacrilege. Finally, Raja Bikram Singh of Faridkot started the electricity by spending his own money on a generator, and the foundation for the electricity was laid on 29-8-1897. In 1930, modernization increased further; today, it is much better.

Devotion from Non-Sikhs-

The sentiment of the Sri Guru Sahibs is for humanity, not just for Sikhs. In this humanity, where there are Sikhs, there are also Hindus, Muslims, non-Sikhs; all worldly congregations, according to the Guru Sahibs' sentiments: "From the One Light, the entire universe welled up. So who is good, and who is bad?" . This is a very great mercy. The Guru Sahib himself has made the congregation such that very loving devotees are sometimes seen among non-Sikhs, whose devotion is

no less than that of Sikhs. This is a play of *karma* (deeds), and such a blessing cannot be upon everyone. Finally, it is special that Sri Darbar Sahib is common to non-Sikhs and is common to all four *varnas* (classes).

57. Ban on making such a design

No one can make a design like Sri Darbar Sahib, thinking, "we will also make such a building or scene" - it is banned. By the way, in those times, the holy sight of Sri Tarn Taran Sahib is similar, but the Sarovar Sahib there is larger than that of Sri Amritsar. The Sri Durgiana Mandir also has a design like Sri Harmandir Sahib, but I saw that the crowd at that holy place is negligible, and when I went around the year 2000, there was no *Langar* there, but there was one shop outside from which we bought and ate *Chole Puri* (chickpeas and fried bread) . I do not know about now. In some places, some people tried to build such a place, but they could not succeed. The prayer is that no one should imitate this.

The First Building-

The first building was completed by Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, and it was started by the grace of Sri Guru Amar Das Ji. Sri Guru Ram Das Ji carried it forward, but the incomplete work was done by the Fifth Patshah, and he enshrined the Sri Adi Granth Sahib - this is a very great grace. Even before its completion, the city began to be settled, and thousands of people (congregation) started coming and settling here, and their devotion to the Guru Sahib made them residents of this place

forever. The construction of the first building was the first major achievement for the Sikhs, and Sri Harmandir Sahib became an attraction not only for Sikhs but for every devotee. The holy place, the house of God, has received great importance to this day and will continue to grow.

The Current Building-

The high spirits of the Sikhs, and the fear of the Singhs who broke the back of the plunderers or drove the foreigners out of Hindustan, became so great that they (the enemies) began to hunt and kill the Singhs, putting prices on their heads. The result was that the plunderers attacked and destroyed Sri Darbar Sahib several times, and Ahmad Shah Abdali even blew it up with gunpowder. Time passed, and then the current building was constructed by *Mistri* (artisan) Bhai Des Raj Ji. You can read more details about this in the book, and you can also learn a lot about the previous one. Please forgive any mistakes.

58. Library

At Sri Darbar, from the time of the Satguru Sahibs, special history and Gurbani or special writings have been preserved with great care. This preservation was done here, deeming this holy place to be safe and appropriate. This precious, invaluable treasure of centuries continued to be accumulated here. This treasure, which is related to writings and includes handwritten manuscripts, is kept with great care. At that time, handwritten manuscripts were the only resource.

This was given the respectable name of 'Library' or 'Tosha Khana'. This treasure is also very great proof. They are preserved in special cupboards, trunks, or boxes. Sikhs from ancient times would deposit this treasure here, thinking their work was done, because no other place felt more holy than this. But dangerous times also came upon the Sikhs.

When the foreign plunderers learned about and recognized the Sikhs, they considered them a major obstacle in their path and made every effort to erase their existence. The great and small *Ghalugharas* (holocausts) and daily massacres continued. The difficult times the Sikhs endured, no other community has faced such difficult times, because these people were (destined) to fight against birth(?) and oppression. These plunderers, from time to time, and in 1984, the Indira Gandhi government, looted, burned, destroyed, and stole from the library. Even today, the library stands.

Koh-i-Noor Diamond-

The Koh-i-Noor diamond is a very valuable diamond, and its history is very long. But when this diamond became the property of Maharaja Ranjit Singh, the treasury became even more vast. Maharajas had a repository of priceless items. The Maharaja was a great devotee of the Sikh Guru Sahibs and performed invaluable services, some of which are mentioned in the book. Time took a turn, and the Maharaja, being late in

understanding the policy of the Dogras, neared his death. He had, from time to time, offered invaluable offerings at Sri Darbar Sahib, which was a great record. But now, before his death, he ordered his Diwan (minister) to bring the Koh-i-Noor diamond and offer it at Sri Harmandir Sahib. The Dogras cleverly stalled, and this diamond eventually reached the British, which today is cut and set in the crown of the Queen there. The Maharaja's wish to donate it could not be fulfilled.

59. Service by Maharaja Ranjit Singh

Sri Darbar Sahib was adorned very beautifully and specially. The devotion of the congregation was increasing day by day. Maharaja Ranjit Singh was a Sikh king who held great devotion. He always considered his victories to be solely the grace of the Guru Sahib. Before marching on Multan, the Maharaja went to the Granthi Sahib of Sri Darbar Sahib, Bhai Sant Singh, and requested him to pray for the victory of Multan. Sant Singh Ji then said, "What service will you perform after winning?". The Maharaja said, "Whatever valuable items I obtain, I will offer them here.". The Ardas was done, the Maharaja was victorious, and the Maharaja offered the conquered gold, silver, diamonds, jewels, and other valuable items at Sri Darbar Sahib. Valuable items were also offered to temples and mosques. Now, Bhai Sant Singh, with great worry, concern, and hard work, had the service of the gold done with integrity. In 1803, the Maharaja entrusted 5 lakhs worth of gold, and *Mistri* (artisan) Muhammad Yar Khan did the gold

work. The Maharaja's name was then inscribed at the entrance, and the service is mentioned as being by the grace of Sri Guru Ram Das Ji. During the Khalsa Raj, 64 lakh 11,000 worth of gold and finishing expenses were incurred. This service was performed with great devotion by the Maharaja, Sikh warriors, Sikh governments, and devotees, who contributed enthusiastically to the gold work. Along with the Maharaja, Sardar Hukam Singh Sahib, S. Fateh Singh Ahluwalia, Sikh Generals, Rani Sada Kaur, Ghaneyya Misl, Bhai Ram Singh Pachauria, Bhai Gurmukh Singh, Bhai Chain Singh, Bhai Bhag Singh, Bhai Fateh Singh, Sardar Basant Singh Kheri Walian, Maharaja Kharak Singh, Maharaja Kharak Singh's mother, Maharaja Nau Nihal Singh, and his mother Maharani Chand Kaur, and other devotees performed service of gold, silver, marble, diamonds, and valuable items with great devotion in ancient times. And even today, it is essential that the devoted offering of gold, silver, diamonds, and rare, priceless items from various corners of the world continues, and it will continue . Although at Darbar Sahib, devotion is valued more than gold and silver, even a *kaudi* (shell) has more value, the Guru Sahib accepts every true devotion of a Sikh. I am thankful for the additional information provided by scholars. May the Guru give a holy place to everyone's hard work - this is the prayer. May my mistakes be forgiven. Thank you.

60. Why attacks on Sri Darbar Sahib? - 1

There is mention of Sri Darbar Sahib existing for ages, even before worldly humans, but some scholars may not agree with this. We certainly believe this mention, hearing and seeing some tales and stories of holy souls coming to this holy place for centuries or ages to meditate. The rest, the holy building (Gurdwara Sahib) here, by the grace of Sri Guru Amar Das Ji, was (built) on the site given by King Akbar to his daughter Bibi Bhani, the wife of Sri Guru Ram Das Ji, out of devotion, giving Bibi Bhani the status of his own daughter and writing a deed. On that site, according to the Guru Sahib's command, Sri Guru Ram Das Ji, along with prominent Sikhs like Baba Buddha Ji, Bhai Gurdas Ji, etc., went and started the city of Sri Amritsar Sahib, which exists today. A large number of Sikhs began to come here with devotion, and the Guru Sahib settled all types of artisans. The congregation started coming and settling in large numbers. The Guru Ji is all-knowing; he understood about the holy pilgrimage bath here, which is why the Guru Ji.... The town or city being established was named Ramdaspur, Chak Ramdas, Guru Da Chak, and finally, it is now famous as Sri Amritsar Sahib. The Guru Sahib manifested and established the holy pilgrimage sites that had been established here for centuries, among which one is Sri Santokhsar and the second is Sri Darbar Sahib. Here, the congregation began to be saved through *darshan* and bathing, and its uniqueness grew in the world.

Great sanctity was maintained regarding its construction. Among the devotees from abroad, the number of non-Sikhs is also very high. NRI devotees from abroad are performing enhanced services in every aspect with devotion. The construction started by Sri Guru Ram Das Ji was completed by Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, and the great grace (and) very great work he did was establishing the Sri Adi Granth Sahib there. Now, this became a Sri Tirath (pilgrimage site), and secondly, the manifestation of Bani - this was a very big thing. Because of such a great work, the congregation's coming here and making their life successful became a great spiritual attraction. The faith connected here removed doubts, and Sri Harmandir became dearer than life. For this reason, and secondly, because of the new tradition of the two swords of Miri and Piri by Sri Hargobind Sahib, the congregation's attraction and yearning increased. The rule of the Mughals and Pathans wanted to make the country... (Islamic?), but the method they adopted was one of oppression. Whoever accepts Islam will be spared; opponents began to be killed.

61. Why attacks on Sri Darbar Sahib? - 2

Finally, tension grew between the Sikhs and the occupying foreign plunderers because it was the Sikhs who raised their voice against the ongoing oppression and snatched back the looted goods and the women who were forcibly taken by the plunderers. The Sikhs had now become a danger to the plunderers, and they

(the plunderers) had resolved to eliminate this danger. They found out about the Sikhs that their religious place, Sri Harmandir Sahib, is the special center of the Sikhs, and they fight against oppression after having *darshan* and bathing there, and truth is victorious . The plunderers, who had armies and lakhs of soldiers, (saw) that a handful of Sikhs were breaking their backs in battle, which is why Sri Harmandir Sahib began to be an eyesore to the plunderers. Now, by making various schemes, they decided to capture Sri Harmandir Sahib, desecrate it, and finally destroy it. The paths to Sri Darbar Sahib were closed; lakhs of soldiers and armies desecrated it, and from time to time, various sinners committed great sins. Their sinful actions are mentioned in the book, and what happened after the sacrileges. By whom and when were the attacks carried out, and how the Sikhs settled the score with these sinners, is mentioned in the book by the Guru's grace. These plunderers, with their power, murdered 50,000 and 30,000 Sikhs in a single day. The Sikhs had to live hiding in jungles; prices were put on Sikhs' heads, which is mentioned in the book. Finally, difficult times came, and the Sikhs, by the Guru's grace, turned very powerful kings and generals to dust. Seeing a single Sikh fighting against 1.25 lakh, a Sikh fighting with his head on his palm, a Sikh being cleft in two, a Sikh being flayed alive, Sikhs climbing *charkhries* (spiked wheels) and shouting victory slogans - the plunderers began to see defeat on all sides, and seeing the heavy losses, the

plunderers were forced to flee Hindustan. Hindustan was finally, by the grace of the Sikhs and Sri Darbar Sahib, freed from the hands of the plunderers and given to the Sikhs for service, but for this, the Sikhs had to make very great sacrifices. From this short article, it must have become quite clear to you why the attacks on Sri Darbar Sahib happened, and may the Guru have mercy, it is not known what the Guru has willed for this (conflict) still. Prayers are made here for the welfare of all. Anyone can come here; there is no caste, color, discrimination, high or low, rich or poor - there is no difference. Please, by the grace (of God), after reading this book, you will surely be able to know something about the acceptance, peace, liberation, devotion, and power of the Sri Darbar Sahib *Parkarma* . It is requested that you accept the service done by this humble servant through this writing, but if someone has more of the Guru's grace, then thank you, do the service, do not belittle the other.

62. The Martyrdom of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji

The great service of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji towards Sri Harmandir Sahib becomes clear to you in the book. The blessings that the Guru Sahib bestowed by founding Sri Darbar Sahib, Sri Amritsar Sahib, Sri Tarn Taran, and other cities and towns, and for the flourishing of *Sikhi* (Sikhism) - the pen of any human does not have the wisdom to write them, but by the Guru's grace, the author definitely performs some service. Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji completed Sri Darbar Sahib, and seeing the

specialties of how he himself performed service with his own hands along with the congregation, Sikhs would sacrifice themselves for the Guru Sahib. The lights of Sri Adi Granth Sahib, Kirtan, accepting God's will (Bhana), and humility shown by the Guru Sahib are showing the path to the world today. The Darbar Sahib became the 'Mecca' of the Sikh nation, and Sikhs began to become powerful by having *darshan* and bathing. It was natural for this to become a threat to the opposing plunderers because they did not want to let a new religion rise. Actions to crush this problem began. Now, all eyes were on Sri Darbar Sahib, and on the Sikh Guru, Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, and the Sri Adi Guru Granth Sahib. False news was given to the country's king, Jahangir, against the Guru Sahib, and the false accusation was made that the Sri Adi Granth Sahib was against Islam. The refusal to marry the daughter of Lahore's *Subedar's* (Governor's) *Diwan* (Minister), Chandu, to the Guru Sahib's son, Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib, the refusal to pay fines... etc., accusations were leveled. Seeing the true answers from Sri Guru Arjan Dev and his unwavering sentiment, the Guru Ji was summoned to Lahore . The Guru Sahib knew the time for martyrdom had come. Entrusting the responsibilities to his son, Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib, the Guru Sahib left for Lahore. There, for not agreeing to all their terms, and finally, upon hearing the sentence of being seated on a hot *Tavi* (iron plate) and having hot sand poured on his head to be martyred, Sain Mian Mir, Chandu's

daughter-in-law, other Pirs, and the congregation protested, but the Guru Sahib, telling everyone his sentiment of "Your actions seem sweet to me," and explaining the sentiment of martyrdom, attained martyrdom. The first martyr Guru of the Sikhs started the tradition of martyrdoms and raised the voice of truth and justice. Even today, those connoisseurs of martyrdom take light from Sri Amritsar, Sri Darbar Sahib, or, according to the circumstances, from the *Prakash* (light/guidance) of Sri Guru Granth Sahib to illuminate and pave their path. The tradition of martyrdoms was started by the Guru Sahib, and the Sikh, in high spirits, always places his head on his palm for the Guru Sahib and gets martyred. I am an applicant for forgiveness for writing about the blessings of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji for Sri Darbar Sahib on a short page, but please forgive any mistakes and accept these few words.

63. Attacks on Sri Darbar Sahib

Sri Darbar Sahib is dearer to Sikhs than life, and more than 8 attacks have been made to destroy its honor and glory, but their result was that the attacker was ground into the dust. Time has rolled even their graves into the dust. The attackers' thinking was that Sri Darbar Sahib is the *Amrit Kund* (Pool of Nectar) and the center of power and devotion for the Sikhs, and that the Sikhs have made the greatest sacrifices to keep Hindustan as Hindustan by successfully fighting them. Especially, the plunderers, traveling a long distance

from Turkey and Afghanistan, looted Hindustan's honor extensively, but the Sikhs, through a long struggle, have always brought it to high spirits (Chardi Kala).

Although there is mention of seven major attacks, from time to time, when prices were put on Sikhs' heads, the plunderers considered it their religious duty to commit sacrilege and constantly performed misdeeds here. The Sikh religion was new, but the way they maintained its honor is exemplary. In 1737, the first attack occurred during the time of Bhai Mani Singh, the product of which was Massa Ranghar. His mention can be read in a bit more detail in the book. The 1757 sacrilege occurred during Abdali's fourth attack, and Shaheed Baba Deep Singh Ji settled this score; read more in the book. In 1762, Abdali carried out the *Vadda Ghalughara* (Great Holocaust) and again desecrated Sri Harmandir Sahib; the conditions were dire. In 1764, Abdali attacked again; Bhai Gurbakhsh Singh brought forces from Sri Anandpur Sahib and fought back. In 1955, during the formation of the Punjabi Suba, the Congress government fired shells for four days, beat the congregation, and the Kirtan and Langar were also stopped. In 1984, Indira Gandhi attacked for 8 days, and the damage that occurred cannot be written, but she was punished by Bhai Beant Singh and Bhai Satwant Singh on October 31, 1984. Bhai Beant Singh (died) that same day, and later, Bhai Kehar Singh and Bhai Satwant Singh were hanged on January 6, 1986. In 1986, Surjit Singh Barnala carried out Operation Black Thunder, and

his future was finished. In 1988, during Black Thunder (II), the Singhs were forced out, and cases were filed. On 2-12-2024, ex-Deputy Chief Minister Sukhbir Singh Badal admitted to the sacrilege in front of the Jathedars, and on 4-12-2024, Bhai Narain Singh Chaura fired at him. People are viewing this with their own perspectives. May Waheguru keep us in high spirits in the future and may sacrilege not happen.

64. Great Service by Baba Gurbakhsh Singh-

The bravery and sacrifice of Baba Gurbakhsh Singh Ji have earned a special name in the history of Sri Harmandir Sahib, and he has received the Guru's blessings. When Ahmad Shah Abdali came to plunder Hindustan for the tenth time, his looting Pathans came to Sri Harmandir Sahib and began to dishonor it. The Sikh world came to know of this, and the Sikhs present there were martyred by the army. Great sacrilege occurred, but difficult times were upon the Sikhs. When Baba Gurbakhsh Singh Ji at Sri Anandpur Sahib learned of this news, he could not bear it. The situation was bad, and the Sikhs were also fighting for their time while living in the jungles. Baba Ji ordered the Sikhs to prepare to stop the sacrilege of Sri Darbar Sahib. The number of Singhs was negligible, but after offering an Ardas (prayer), the Singhs, under the leadership of Baba Gurbakhsh Singh, mounted their horses and marched towards Sri Amritsar. The journey was long, but the zeal

of the warriors was making the journey end very quickly. Baba Ji, along with his 30 Singhs, reached Sri Darbar Sahib. On the other side, Abdali's 30,000 troops also arrived. He (Baba Ji), along with his Singhs, bowed his head at Sri Darbar Sahib, offered an Ardas, and skillfully held back the forces trying to enter. The Singhs continued to be martyred, and Baba Ji, shouting victory slogans, showed such valor to the forces that the battle seemed like magic to the army. After cutting down countless enemies, finally, a blow landed on his neck, and his head was cut off. Even without a head, Baba Ji continued to fight with great bravery and finally attained martyrdom. History bestows special words upon this battle. Here, near Sri Akal Takht Sahib, a Gurdwara Sahib for Baba Ji is built; Jatha Baba Sube Singh built it. Baba Gurbakhsh Singh Ji had become the Jathedar after the martyrdom of Baba Deep Singh Ji, and Baba Ji's martyrdom is considered to be on December 4th. Another special point is that when leaving Sri Anandpur Sahib, the Guru Sahib had given the responsibility of that place to Baba Gurbakhsh Singh Ji alone, and he served Sri Anandpur Sahib with his body and mind, fully dedicated . This task was very difficult, and by the Guru Sahib's grace, he fulfilled the task successfully. Just as Baba Ji was a great warrior, he was also a scholar, a writer, and a servant of the Guru Sahib who meditated with every breath. His father's name was Bhai Dasonda Singh, and his mother was Sri Lachhmi. He took *Amrit* (was initiated) from Sri Guru

Gobind Singh at the age of 11. His mother passed away when he was fifteen, and he began to live with the Guru Sahib. He received education from Baba Deep Singh and showed valor in battles. He also performed the service of transcribing Bani.

65. Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh

The connection of Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh with Sri Darbar Sahib is very special, and therefore, it is very important to write about them. The oppression of Nader Shah on Hindustan grew day by day. He looted rampantly, but finally, the Guru's Khalsa, as the only ones to stop him, entered the field in such a way that Nader Shah's worries increased. Nader appointed Zakariya Khan as the governor of Punjab in 1726, and it was from him that Nader got the chance to hear the tales of the Sikhs. Nader finally, to erase the name and trace of the Sikhs, made an announcement, proclaiming to eliminate the Sikhs. A reward of a blanket or quilt for cutting a Sikh's *Kes* (hair), ten rupees for providing information, and 50 rupees for killing a Sikh was announced, which led to people starting a new trade. The hunting of Sikhs began, and Sikhs eventually had to live in jungles and secret locations. But by making new policies, the Sikhs began to succeed in inflicting heavy losses on the government forces. Many people started cutting the hair of women and claiming rewards by passing them off as Sikhs. Those

who harmed Sikhs began to receive *Jagirs* (land grants) and become *Chaudharis* (headmen). Knowing the importance of the Sikhs' Sri Darbar Sahib, Massa (Ranghar) was made a *Chaudhary* for committing sacrilege and was given control of Sri Darbar Sahib. Massa's power had in any case increased, and he had become infamous for his extreme cruelty in crushing the Sikhs. The news that he had filled in the Sarovar to tie his horses and had started holding mujras (dance performances) and smoking *Hukka* (tobacco pipe) inside Sri Darbar Sahib was delivered by Bhai Balaka Singh to the Singhs sitting in the jungles of Rajasthan. Hearing the Jathedar ask for a warrior to rise and bring Massa's head, the young Bhai Sukha Singh (a carpenter from Mari Kamboki, Amritsar) and Bhai Mehtab Singh (from Mira Kot, Amritsar) shouted victory slogans and prepared themselves. After offering an Ardas, the two Singhs, in due time, arrived near Sri Darbar Sahib. From a mound, they chipped pieces of broken earthen pots, filled a bag, and, under the pretext of paying revenue money, they managed to reach Sri Darbar Sahib, tied their horses near the Lachi Beri, and succeeded in going inside. Reaching Massa with the bag, they were filled with zeal upon seeing the situation. They told Massa it was the revenue, threw the bag under his cot, and Massa was happy. As he bent down to pick up the bag, Bhai Sukha Singh beheaded him with his sword, and Bhai Mehtab Singh impaled the head on his spear. Shouting victory slogans, they swiftly leaped into their

horses' saddles, and with the head impaled on the spear, they sped their horses away. The terrified government forces scattered here and there. The Singhs returned and presented Massa's head to the Jathedar, taking revenge for Sri Darbar Sahib. Even today, the community takes inspiration from this sacrifice. Blessed are these great Singhs - Victory!.

66. Where did the Singhs arrive after beheading Massa Ranghar?

The arrogant Massa, to commit sacrilege, had, in his hubris, filled in the Sri Sarovar Sahib and tied his horses there, and inside, he had set up a cot and was watching courtesans dance. News of this was delivered by Bhai Balaka Singh to the Jathedar of the Singhs hiding in the jungles of Ganga Nagar, Rajasthan, and he began to weep profusely. The Jathedar, after some thought, appealed to the Singhs to teach the sacrilegious Massa Ranghar a lesson. Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh took up this service. After offering an Ardas and some deliberation, they saddled their swift horses from there. The journey was long, and the zeal to take revenge kept increasing. Arriving near Sri Amritsar Sahib, they made a plan and prayed to the Guru Sahib. From a mound there, they collected broken pot shards, rounded them, and put them in a sack. They reached Sri Darbar Sahib in disguise. They convinced Massa's forces that they were *Lambardars* (village headmen) who had come to pay revenue to *Chaudhary* Massa.

The Singhs also promised the greedy soldiers some money from the bag afterward, and upon seeing Massa committing sacrilege inside, their zeal was uncontrollable. Bhai Sukha Singh, saying he was giving the revenue, threw the bag under the cot. Massa was happy and, as he tried to pick up the bag to throw money at the prostitutes, Bhai Mehtab Singh beheaded Massa with a single blow of his sword, and Bhai Sukha Singh impaled the head on his spear. Those present (Massa's men) began to hide upon seeing the Singhs' bravery. The Singhs, shouting victory slogans, reached their horses. Seeing the head of the arrogant, powerful Massa dripping blood and impaled on a spear, the terrified forces panicked. A hue and cry arose all around at the sight.

How they reached Baba Buddha Johar-

From Sri Darbar Sahib, Sri Amritsar, with Massa's head impaled on the spear, the Singhs mounted their horses. When they shouted victory slogans, everyone panicked upon seeing the head on the spear. The hiding and fleeing army began to scatter to save their lives. The warrior Singhs wheeled their horses around at that spot, a mark of which is made in the Darbar Sahib *Parkarma* in the form of a circle. The rest, seeing everyone fleeing, the swift horses, obeying their masters' commands, began to fly like the wind. In a short while, they were on the jungle path. Meanwhile, when Ranghar's forces regained their senses, they saw Massa's bloodied, writhing torso had grown cold. The

musicians, prostitutes, and all others were emerging from their hiding places. On the other side, the Singhs, covering the long journey, stopped at Hanumangarh for the night. In the early morning, they started their journey again and reached their fellow Singhs sitting in the jungles with the head impaled. Seeing the Singhs' service, great victory slogans resounded. Time passed, and the chief of the Nihang Singhs, Baba Buddha Johar, saw the "flames" (spirit) of the martyred Singhs here, and this place, where the head was brought after the beheading, became manifest. Then, Baba Buddha Ji Nihang established the largest Gurdwara Sahib of Rajasthan here and manifested the beautiful Gurdwara by the name of 'Buddha Johar'. A very beautiful museum is also being built here. Here, the bravery of the Singhs who beheaded Massa Ranghar is refreshed. This place is near Ganga Nagar, and the congregation arrives in massive numbers.

67. Shaheed Baba Deep Singh Ji

Sri Darbar Sahib is also connected with Shaheed Baba Deep Singh Ji, and it is necessary for me to write about this holy relationship with Baba Ji - although I have a separate book on this, titled "Jau Tau Prem Khelan Ka Chao, Sir Dhar Tali Gali Meri Aao" (If you wish to play the game of love, come to my street with your head on your palm). In this book, even the short form brings the sacrifice of Baba Ji before the eyes . Let us take light from Baba Ji's sacrifice and see how important our-dearer-than-life Sri Harmandir Sahib is.

Baba Ji was born on January 26, 1682, in Pahuwind to mother Sri Jioni and father Sri Bhagta Ji. In childhood, when he came for the *darshan* of the Guru Sahib with the congregation from his village, he refused to go back to the village, and his firm decision to stay with the Guru Sahib was successful. Staying with the Guru Sahib, he attained the status of a successful scholar, warrior, and preacher. He was a very trustworthy figure for the Guru Ji. Time passed, and the Guru Sahib's family was separated at the Sarsa river. Two sons and beloved Singhs were martyred in the *Kachi Garhi* (mud fortress) of Chamkaur. The Guru Sahib's plea to the "Dear Friend" (God), "Mitr Piare Nu... Haal Mureedan Da Kehna,"... one can easily understand the situation . Over there, the younger sons were martyred in the walls of Sirhind, and Mata Ji (Gujri) taking them along, merged into the Guru's lap. The Guru's family became homeless. Finally, the Satguru opened his *Kamarkassa* (waist-band) at Damdama Sahib and, when the *Bir* (volume) was not received from the Dhir Mallias, he himself composed the Sri Guru Granth Sahib through Bhai Mani Singh Ji and Baba Deep Singh Ji. Upon completing this service here, the Guru Sahib Ji, expressing his pleasure, gave Baba Deep Singh Ji a *Bachan* (promise) to ask for anything, (and said) that his Sikhi would be fulfilled with every breath. When the Guru Sahib left Damdama Sahib, Baba Ji stayed there, continuing the service of preaching and writing. But when he learned of the sacrilege of Sri Darbar Sahib, he

offered an Ardas from there and set out with 500 Singhs to liberate Sri Darbar Sahib. More congregations joined along the way. All the Singhs crossed the line of sacrifice drawn by him and, placing their heads on their palms, shouted victory slogans for the battle. Baba Ji had vowed to bow his head at Sri Darbar Sahib after liberating it. A fierce battle ensued. The heads of the enemies were rolling like watermelons, and Singhs were also being martyred, but still, the battle seemed to be in the Singhs' favor. Finally, with a single blow, the heads of Baba Deep Singh Ji and Jamal Khan were cut. A nearby Singh reminded Baba Deep Singh Ji of his vow, upon which Baba Ji, whose (body) was on the ground, placed his severed head on his palm and wielded his *Khanda* (double-edged sword) in such a way that the enemy, seeing this sight, fled the battlefield. Winning the field, Baba Ji liberated Sri Darbar Sahib and created history by bowing his head in the *Parkarma*. At that spot, the *Nishan* (mark/Gurdwara) of Baba Deep Singh Ji, even today, refreshes the memory of that sacrifice, and the congregation begins to utter, "Dhan Baba Deep Singh Ji" (Blessed is Baba Deep Singh Ji).

68. Shaheed Bhai Mani Singh Ji

Whenever Sri Harmandir Sahib is mentioned or the sentiment for *darshan* arises, the sacrifice of Shaheed Bhai Mani Singh Ji comes to mind. Bhai Mani Singh was such a Sikh among Sikhs that seeing and hearing the

sacrifices of his family, who became the (foundation) of the earth in the service of the Guru Sahib, lakhs and crores of heads bow. Bhai Mani Singh Ji was born at... and along with his father, Bhai Mai Das, he was taken to the court of Sri Guru Har Rai Sahib, where Bhai Sahib's bond of love for the Guru was forged strongly. Bhai Sahib began to perform services while staying in the court, and such was the grace that he remained engrossed in reading Gurbani. He was foremost in cleaning and scrubbing the utensils. At the age of fifteen, his father took him from the village with the Guru Sahib's permission to get him married. He was married to Bibi Seeto, the daughter of Bhai Lakhi Shah Vanjara, but then he, along with his elder brothers Bhai Jetha Ji and Bhai Dayala Ji, returned to the Guru's sanctuary. He remained in the service of Sri Guru Har Krishan Ji and was also with him at the time of going to Delhi. Then he came for the *darshan* of the Guru Sahib at Baba Bakala and joined the service of Guru Sri Tegh Bahadur Ji. Bhai Dayala Ji, who was boiled in a cauldron in Delhi, was his brother. After the martyrdom of Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Sahib, he dedicated his every breath to the service of Sri Guru Gobind Singh. His childhood name was Bhai Mania, but after taking *Amrit* (initiation), he became Bhai Mani Singh Ji. When he took *Amrit*, his five sons and three brothers also took it with him. The Guru Sahib entrusted him with special services. At Sri Damdama Sahib, during the scribing of Sri Guru Granth Sahib, he, along with Baba Deep Singh

Ji, completed the service. Pleased, the Guru Sahib asked him to ask for anything, and he asked for the boon of maintaining his Sikhi with his *Kes* (uncut hair) intact. Grace was bestowed. When the time came, due to his refusal to pay 1,17,100,000 *take* (currency) and the Mughals' sentiment to teach the Sikhs a lesson and desecrate Sri Harmandir Sahib, the result was that Zakariya Khan had him martyred in Lahore by cutting him limb by limb. You are the first martyr in the world to be cut limb by limb, but you did not forsake your faith. Bhai Subeg Singh performed his last rites in Lahore. The Singhs later punished his executioners and torturers. The precious martyrdom of Bhai Sahib seems fresh even today. His 10 sons and 11 brothers were also martyred and never allowed any lapse in the service of the Guru Sahib. Bhai Bachittar Singh, who fought the elephant, was his son. Read more details about this family in my book, "Mera Bandh Bandh Katto" (Cut me joint by joint). The sacrifice of Bhai Mani Singh is connected with the Sikh community and Sri Darbar Sahib. Writing one page about him is very little, but may it be accepted, and please forgive my mistakes.

69. Massa Ranghar

The arrogant Massa Ranghar, thinking himself mighty and powerful, took on the challenge of eliminating the Sikhs and destroying Sri Darbar Sahib, but his arrogance did not allow him to understand the precious sentiments of the Sikhs for Harmandir Sahib. In his arrogance, he committed great sacrilege and

turned the house of God into a den for a prostitute's dance. You can read the result of this in a separate book. Think with a calm mind about Bhai Sukha Singh and Bhai Mehtab Singh Ji, who became Massa's death, and about their sacrifice and service, and read a little more detail in the book. In the future, may no one think of becoming a Massa Ranghar, because even today, lakhs of Bhai Sukha Singhs and Bhai Mehtab Singhs stand ready for Sri Darbar Sahib.

Abdali-

Abdali looted India extensively and also stole its daughters and brides. All the Hindu warriors bowed their heads before him, and he played Holi with blood, reddening the famous streets and markets of Hindustan. Just as Abdali made Hindustan his prey, in the end, the Singhs performed the greatest service of driving him out of Hindustan and took revenge for every single sin. The Sikhs would have forgiven him, but when he desecrated Sri Harmandir Sahib, his pot of sins was full. This is not just about him; if anyone looks at Darbar Sahib with the same mindset as Abdali, they cannot be spared.

Indira Gandhi-

Indira Gandhi had a good relationship with the Sikhs, but sometimes political people, in the intoxication of their power, forget a lot and start committing acts of self-will against religion, righteousness, and compassion. Whoever has picked a

fight with any religion that connects one to God and stands up for truth and justice day and night, they are destroyed. Indira Gandhi's biggest mistake was the senseless attack she carried out on Sri Darbar Sahib. There were other solutions for this, but due to the arrogance of power, she was killed by someone's hand. Due to the arrogance of power, her sons were also killed. Taking refuge at Sri Darbar Sahib is liberation, and one who commits sacrilege always endures pain and hell.

Etc.-

To this day, hundreds, thousands, lakhs, and perhaps crores of other sinners have come to commit sacrilege at Sri Darbar Sahib, and we have seen, heard, and read the results. We do not know about many sins and sinners because, due to their sins, they were ground into the dust in such a way that they became dust; their names and traces were erased. Where are Abdali, Aurangzeb, Babur, Indira, Brar? The rest are also remaining, whose honor has fallen from the skies to the floor. The end of such people is worse than hell. It is the love of Harmandir Sahib to embrace those who come to its sanctuary.

70. Sri Darbar Sahib liberated from the Mahants

After the martyrdom of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, the holy soil that was kept to one side was leveled, and the True King, Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib Ji, established Sri Akal

Takht Sahib. He fought four battles, secured the victory of justice, and became the True King. Alongside this, the elder brother of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, Baba Prithi Chand Ji, due to not receiving the Guruship, kept trying hard to show the congregation that he was the Guru and, colluding with the Mughal kings, kept doing many things. In this endeavor, various people with ill intentions succeeded in capturing Sri Darbar Sahib and committing acts of self-will (Manmatian). The congregation remained very distressed and was always worried about liberating it from the wrong hands. Among these, although the sacrilegious people did this work with the help of the administration, the great personality of the area at that time, Sant Baba Lakhbir Singh Ji—whose picture has now been adorned in the museum at Sri Darbar Sahib on 24-10-2024—made a very big contribution to liberating Sri Darbar Sahib from the *Mahants*, a history very few people know . This great soul was the father of Bhai Mehtab Singh Bir, the chief of the Khalsa Bahadur. Bhai Mehtab Singh Ji Bir earned a great name in history through his service. At the event held at Jallianwala Bagh on 10-11-12 October 1920, he performed the great deed of initiating the brotherhood of the backward classes, who were even prevented from taking *Amrit* (initiation) by the rulers of that time. His great service here was that, by the Guru's grace, he drove out the *Mahants* who were installed by the British. Thanking the Guru millions of times, he formed an organization to take over the service and

management, which was named the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee, and one month after this, the Shiromani Akali Dal came into existence. This great task was placed in the lap of the Panth (Sikh nation) by Bhai Mehtab Singh Ji Bir through sacrifices and tireless hard work. He also liberated other Gurdwaras, and his family, his great-grandson Bhai Avtar Singh Ji Khalsa, remains present in service today, ever-ready for every task of the Panth . Please, may the honor of this family be maintained. Phone Bhai Avtar Singh Ji 94170-02710. Author S. Davinder Singh Thamanwal Holland 0031-615523439.

71. The 1984 Attack- 1

The Sikh nation has emerged for struggle, and Akal Purakh Ji has adorned this beloved and... community and given birth to (manifested) the Khalsa. The Khalsa fights less for itself and more for the world, meaning it performs benevolence. The earnings of the 36 great souls, from Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji onwards, guide us to liberation through the leadership of Sri Guru Granth Sahib, bestowing the mercy of supreme inspiration. We are fortunate that the Sri Adi Granth Sahib to the Sri Guru Granth Sahib Ji is connected with Sri Darbar Sahib, and the path of world welfare begins from here. You can understand the light regarding Sri Darbar Sahib abundantly and easily in the book. That is why not just Sikhs, but every particle of the world yearns for the *darshan* and *ishnan* (bathing) of Sri Darbar Sahib Ji. Sri Akal Purakh Sahib himself also came here for *darshan*

and service, and is always present. The *Prakash* (manifestation) of Sri Darbar Sahib has happened; the devotee's devotion towards it is overwhelming, and fortunes awaken. But those who hold ill intentions towards it have to wander for lifetimes and suffer the blows of *Jam* (death). From time to time, falsehood has committed sin and desecrated this Harmandir of Truth, but those who understand it have always maintained its sanctity in every way, and in the future, the battle of truth and falsehood will continue. For a Sikh, Sri Darbar Sahib is especially dearer than life, and he always wants to see it pure, but the battle of truth and falsehood is to continue forever, and Sri Harmandir Sahib will remain the form of inspiration. In this series, the saga of attacks and sacrileges here is to continue, and in the time to come, *Dharam Morche* (religious agitations) and *Dharam Yudh* (righteous wars), the battle of truth and falsehood, is to remain the *Amrit* (nectar) on this holy land . No one can destroy *Amrit*; it is the unparalleled gift of God, which even the gods and goddesses yearn for. The book, within its capacity and under the Guru Sahib's command, moves through the previous attacks and sacrileges. But here, this humble servant tries to write about the 1984 attack because this attack happened during this humble author's lifetime, and he endured the pain of it himself and saw the people (congregation) crying out in pain. In 1984, at the time of the attack, I myself had been settled in Holland for a long time. For some time, the situation in Punjab

had deteriorated significantly due to the demands for rights and the Nirankari incident. The bugle of struggle had been sounded in Punjab. Under the order of Sri Akal Purakh, the struggle, with prayers from Sri Akal Takht Sahib, grew and rose higher every day. This struggle created problems for the governments. (Tensions) began to fill, and to suppress it, the rising of the governmental-

72. The 1984 Attack- 2

-system became inevitable. Some called it terrorism, some tried to create a rift between Hindus and Sikhs, and some powers gave it the name of "teaching the Sikhs a lesson". Murders began to happen at this time. These were murders of Sikhs, of tyrants, of government officers, of policemen, and of anti-Sikh forces. At this time, Sant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale emerged as this militant figure, and the struggle for rights began, in which the youth started joining him. As time passed, the governments began to see their struggle as a threat to Punjab or Hindustan, but the political leaders of Punjab got busy playing politics. On one hand, they would call him "Sant Ji, Sant Ji" and touch his knees, and on the other hand, they gathered to lay the foundation for finishing the Sants by holding secret meetings with the central government. The Sants' struggle had become armed . They were learning that

to crush this struggle, the political leaders of Punjab were playing a double-game and playing tricks to eliminate them. Finally, they came and sat at Sri Darbar Sahib. From Mehta to Sri Darbar Sahib, they had made clear the method of the impending attack to the congregation. The lakhs of devotees connected with them were also in the field with their heads on their palms. Finally, the fox-like cunning of the political people, to remove the thorn in their path, wrote letters, held meetings, and brought the army to every inch of Punjab's land. There is also a history of the army rehearsing the attack by creating a model of Sri Darbar Sahib far away. In Sri Amritsar, the army, which is used to engage with foreign countries, was present on every inch with war equipment. In Punjab, in the month of May 1984, there was an atmosphere of fear, but on the other hand, Sant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale and (his men) at the Sri Darbar Sahib complex knew that the army would attack . His experienced general, Bhai Subeg Singh, had set up the fortifications inside. The army had come close, and the city was under curfew. As it was the martyrdom day of Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji, there was a large congregation. An announcement was also made from inside that if the army attacked first, "we will make history". The Sants' warriors, with their heads on their palms, sat wearing the threads of martyrdom, mocking death. Finally, the army tightened the siege, and after imposing a curfew in the city, and as the *Jaloos* (procession) began, they prepared for the

attack and gave a warning over the speakers for the congregation to come out. Many devotees came out. In the end, the Sants' Singhs held their ground. As a result, the firing that had started on June 1st began. The first martyr in this was Bhai Mehanga Singh, who was hit by a bullet in the head, and his (cremation) inside-

73. The 1984 Attack - 3

...was cremated right there. Now, the battle was fully certain. Anti-Sikh forces had given Indira Gandhi their consent to attack and even demolish the Sikhs' Harmandir. The politicians sitting inside were waiting for the elimination of the Sants. Finally, hearing the message from inside of non-compliance, the speed of the gunfire, which had been ongoing since June 1st, 1984, intensified on June 3-4. The Indian Army, treating it as a battlefield, saw their announcement for the Sants and Singhs inside to come out fail. They sent elite commandos inside, and the Singhs killed them all. Whatever army came inside, the Singhs, from secret positions, would thwart the attack. The army began to suffer heavy losses, and seeing other operations fail and the army's blood being spilled, the army now attempted aerial attacks and used tanks. The Singhs destroyed the first two or three tanks as well. Angered by this loss, the army, using dangerous resources and cannons, launched a very heavy attack on June 5-6,

destroying Sri Akal Takht, the water tank, the Bungas, and secret hideouts by the morning of June 6th.

Most of Sant Jarnail Singh's Singhs, who were not in very large numbers, were martyred. But according to the Indian Army, the loss to the force was greater than in the wars with Pakistan. There is proof of this in books.

Sant Jarnail also attained martyrdom fighting in this... (cut off) and his body was found in the courtyard of Sri Akal Takht Sahib. On June 6th, there was heavy destruction, and there were bodies and blood everywhere. Now this news spread throughout the world. The destruction inside, the fish dead from poison dissolved in the Sarovar, the riddled and collapsed Sri Akal Takht Sahib, the wounded Sri Darbar Sahib (Sri Harmandir Sahib), the bullets lodged in Sri Guru Granth Sahib, the smoke rising from the remaining buildings, and the lying bodies were impossible to see or hear about. There was outrage everywhere. The army displayed the weapons captured from the Singhs and, loading the bodies into garbage trucks, took them away and burned them. Thousands of people (congregation) were arrested, tortured for years, and locked in jails.

Under the army's supervision, Baba Janta Singh repaired the destruction, but the outrage of the

congregation led them to tear down and rebuild Sri Akal Takht. Even today, the scars of this attack can be seen on Sri Darbar Sahib, and the bodies of the martyrs appear as sentiments. Even today, by 2025, the Sikh nation has not been able to forget the martyrdom of the Sants and the attack, nor is there any hope of forgetting. The political leaders were happy to have the Sants martyred, and their own condition is turning to dust. The one responsible for this attack, PM Indira Gandhi, was killed by her bodyguards, Bhai Satwant Singh and Bhai Beant Singh, in response to which lakhs of Sikhs were destroyed with government backing. The war between truth and falsehood continues. The enemy of Sri Darbar Sahib cannot be spared. Please forgive any mistakes.

74. Shaheed Bhai Beant Singh, Bha: Satwant Singh, Bha: Kehar Singh-

The connection of Bhai Beant Singh, Bhai Satwant Singh, and Bhai Kehar Singh is related to 1984 and Sri Darbar Sahib; therefore, for me to complete this book, it is necessary to try and write from every aspect. You can read in the book what, how, and why the 1984 attack on Sri Darbar Sahib happened. Many Sikhs considered the PM of that time, Srimati Indira Gandhi, to be the culprit for this attack and vowed to kill her. But this task was not easy, or rather, it was impossible. However, it is said that whoever attacks Sri Darbar Sahib dies within 156 days. Bhai Beant Singh and Bhai

Satwant Singh were Indira Gandhi's bodyguards, and as Sikhs, they were also pained by the attack on Sri Darbar Sahib. In 1984, upon hearing the mention of Sri Darbar Sahib during Kirtan by Prof. Darshan Singh in Delhi, Bhai Beant Singh broke down crying profusely. After receiving further inspiration from his relative, Bhai Kehar Singh, Beant Singh decided to kill Indira to take revenge for the attack on Sri Darbar Sahib. For this task, he spoke with one or two other Sikh guards who worked with him, and the young Bhai Satwant Singh pledged to join him. To make their resolve firm, they offered an Ardas (prayer) and took Amrit (initiation). Upon seeing a hawk come and sit on a mango tree at Srimati Indira's house, Bhai Beant Singh considered it to be Sri Guru Gobind Singh's hawk and believed it had come with a message of death. He prayed in his heart for confirmation, and the hawk came and sat on his hand. Their intentions became firm. The two of them made a plan, and on October 31, 1984, when Indira Gandhi arrived in the adjacent part of her house to give an interview, Beant Singh fired on her with his pistol. Right with him, Bhai Satwant Singh, who was a short distance away, emptied his entire carbine magazine, killing Indira on the spot, but they did not harm the two or three other people walking with her. When the other guards arrived, both of them said, "We have done what we had to do, now you do what you have to do." They (the other guards) fired bullets at both of them. Bhai Beant Singh was martyred. Bhai Satwant Singh was

severely injured. Indira Gandhi was dead, but it was confirmed after reaching the hospital. Now, Rajiv Gandhi was made the PM, and in the country, especially in Delhi, thousands of Sikhs were hunted down and killed. Finally, in this case, Bhai Satwant Singh and Bhai Kehar Singh were given the death penalty (hanged) on January 6th. Bhai Beant Singh's village was Maloa, Bhai Satwant Singh's village was Agwan, and Bhai Kehar Singh's village was Mustafabad. Their martyrdom days are commemorated annually at Sri Darbar Sahib, and their families are honored.

75. Bhai Sukha Bhai Jinda-

You can read in the book about the 1984 attack on Sri Darbar Sahib, and what transpired with the Sikhs after the assassination of Indira Gandhi is also not hidden from the world. Due to this anger, lakhs of young men from Punjab took to the path of struggle. Punjab's government affairs call these "black days." The bugle of war had been sounded between the armed youth and the administration, the result of which was painful. There was an atmosphere of terror. It was impossible to leave home at night. Sometimes Singhs were killed, and sometimes administration (personnel) or anti-struggle individuals were killed. At the time of the June 1984 attack on Sri Darbar Sahib, there were three top generals who had command of the army and had managed the entire command of the attack. They were General Vaidya, Sundarji, and Kuldip Singh Brar. You already know the result of the attack, but a fire of

hatred and revenge has not cooled even after lakhs of martyrdoms. Brar's family is destroyed, and his life has become hell. Sundarji died a very bad death. Two Sikhs from Punjab... (text unclear, "chid kiti" - likely "planned" or "staked out") to kill Vaidya and finally found his trail. Several Sikhs were involved in this task, but finally, Sukha and Jinda (Bhai Sukhdev Singh and Harjinder Singh Jinda) one day followed Vaidya, cornered him in his car, and succeeded in killing him. By killing this general, they took revenge for the attack by killing a ringleader general who had attacked Sri Darbar Sahib. The nation considers this act to be in line with ancient traditions. Both these young men were successful in escaping from there after doing this deed, but in time, Jinda was arrested in Delhi and Sukha near Pune. They were caught. The case proceeded, and they said, "We have killed the general who attacked Darbar Sahib. We have no fear, even if we are hanged." The case went on, but... (text unclear, "ittan de" - likely "openly") they confessed to the murder and, upon refusing to ask for forgiveness or mercy, they were sentenced to death by Judge V.L. Ruikar. But the judge, impressed by their bravery, even put their photo in his house. Finally, both Singhs were martyred by hanging on 9-10-1992 (October 9, 1992), at 5 o'clock at Yerwada Jail, Pune. Their victory slogans are seen and heard resounding even today. It is said that upon hearing the death sentence, they made each other's mouths sweet (fed each other sweets). Bhai Jinda's was born in 1961 in the

village of Gadli, Amritsar Sahib. And the hanging was carried out in the early morning of October 9, 1992, and Bhai Sukha was also hanged along with him. Bhai Sukha was born in Chak No. 11, Ganga Nagar, Rajasthan. They had killed Arun Vaidya on August 19, 1986. Bhai Sukha fired the shot; Bhai Jinda was driving the motorcycle. The martyrdom day of Bhai Jinda and Sukha is observed every year.

76. Srimati Indira Gandhi-

Indira Gandhi was the PM of India for a long time, and she had maintained "okay" relations with the Sikhs. But during the Bhindranwale era, accordingto the circumstances, some political people of Punjab, seeing the Sants as a "thorn in the path," succeeded in this task of eliminating them. In 1984, thousands of Singhs were also killed by attacking Darbar Sahib and numerous other Gurdwaras. After attacking and demolishing Sri Akal Takht, Srimati Indira Gandhi came to Darbar Sahib, but she was forcibly wearing a heavy umbrella of security. The anger of the Sikhs was justified, but then, on October 31, 1984, two Sikhs killed her, because of which the relations of many Sikhs with the Congress party soured.

S. Giani Zail Singh Ji-

At the time of the 1984 military attack on Sri Darbar Sahib, S. Giani Zail Singh was the President of India, but he stated that he did not give permission for the attack. It should be remembered that 2-3 days after the attack,

Zail Singh came to Sri Darbar Sahib, and a Singh attacked him from somewhere, but the bullet missed. His big mistake at that time was having an umbrella held over him and having a colored handkerchief in his coat pocket, which is worn during times of happiness. Giani Ji cited letters from some people who had requested the attack to kill the Sants. Giani Ji was eventually killed in an accident, and he had also been the... (text unclear, "chh" - likely "CM") of Punjab.

Shri Rahul Gandhi-

Rahul Gandhi often visits Sri Darbar Sahib. In 2024, he visited multiple times, and once he even performed the service of washing utensils inside for three... (text unclear, "tinn" - three). In November 2024, during his visit, a Sikh girl protested. Many other people said that the 1984 attack cannot be forgotten, and this family's attack is not worthy of forgiveness. Besides Rahul, Sonia Gandhi (mother) and Priyanka (sister) have also visited for *darshan*. Rahul Gandhi wants a good relationship with the Sikhs, and his sister Priyanka is married into a Punjabi family. The rest, what the final outcome between the Panth (Sikh nation) and the Gandhi family will be, only time will tell.

77 . **The thinking of Russia-**

The *Dharam Yudh Morcha* (agitation) began, and due to Punjab's demands, the Anandpur Sahib Resolution, and the injustices being done to the Sikhs, the Sikh political leaders and religious leaders, Sant

Baba Jarnail Singh and Sant Harchand Singh Longowal, stood firm in the agitation. But when the form of this agitation turned towards an armed struggle, it began to create problems for the government. The result reached the point of murders, which were linked to Sant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale. The youth would listen to his every word and come, ready to be martyred. Many people began to see this as a move towards Sikh rule, and some voices began to call it "terrorism." Mischievous people began looting, robbing, and killing. People in Punjab stopped going out at night, and there was no certainty if a person who went out would return home or not. Political figures began to see Sant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale as a "thorn in the path." But no one had the courage to criticize him. All politicians understood the "drama" of praising him and standing with him. The result: In 1984, it was decided to attack Sri Darbar Sahib and eliminate Sant Jarnail Singh and his warriors, which the Sants were aware of. Much thought was needed here, but the politicians of Punjab, along with the Delhi government, England, and Russia, began to agree, but the UK was not coming to the forefront. It is said that Russia even asked PM Indira Gandhi for permission to conduct the attack on Sri Darbar Sahib and guaranteed to "clean up" in an hour or two, but after much thought, this did not happen. The Russians, not caring for religion, could have produced dangerous results, but the Guru Sahib did not let this happen. The result of this arrogance was

such that the ruler there (Gorbachev), in a surprising announcement one morning, broke Russia into pieces, and this punishment was given to the world's biggest power, throwing it on its face. O Holy Congregation, even today, Russia's own Ukraine has made Russia "chew iron grams" (given them a very tough time). If any plunderer or Hindustani thinks of committing sacrilege against Sri Harmandir Sahib, the "stars" (fates) of Indira Gandhi, Abdali, Massa, Zakariya Khan, Lakhpat Rai... etc., will surely be read and brought out. People today have forgotten the name of England's Thatcher, but the ballads of the warriors are still sung.

78. Kali Garaj (Black Thunder) Attack-

We have already written in the book about the 1984 attack on Sri Darbar Sahib. The hearts of Sikhs were wounded by this attack, and many *Kharkus* (militants) were martyred in 1984, but many still survived the major attack. From outside, they then began to take revenge for the atrocities committed against them. Now, a struggle of anger, justice, and revenge began outside. This struggle grew considerably. Every day, sometimes hundreds of Singhs or security forces were being killed. A large number of youth were being arrested, and the consequences began to turn dangerous. Punjab began to go through a dangerous phase. Everyone was in a state of fear. Some people were under the fear of the militants, and some were afraid of the police. Going out of the house became a great fear. The administration was worried about these

conditions, and a large number of Sikhs, pained by the attack on Sri Darbar Sahib, had left their homes to join the struggle, ready to be martyred. During these days, I went to India in 1986, and the situation at that time was such that even in my small village, my mother stopped me from going out in the dark. It was true; no one in the village would leave their home at night. Finally, the administration and intelligence agencies, in April 1986, deployed the National Security Guards (NSG) and, on the night of April 30th and until the morning of May 1st, attacked Sri Darbar Sahib under the name "Operation Black Thunder." They had proof that militants were here. One death occurred in this operation. In total, approximately 1000 security guards took part in the operation, and 200 people were arrested. After this, from May 14 to 19, 1988, "Black Thunder-2" was carried out again because, according to the administration, militants were sitting here. KPS Gill played a special role in these attacks. In this attack, Surjit Singh Penta attained martyrdom by consuming cyanide, and 146 Sikhs were arrested, but no shots were fired. There was no damage like in 1984. This was the story of one of the attacks on Sri Darbar Sahib. All this writing is based on media evidence.

79. **Our Duties-**

This precious human life is the supreme crown of 8.4 million incarnations, and to understand this is humanity's good fortune. The tasks we can perform in this life, we cannot in other lives. Therefore, making

every moment of it successful makes one fortunate. Every person knows or at least hears about the importance of Sri Darbar Sahib. But not everyone gets to come to this holy place, have *darshan*, and perform *seva* (service). The prayers, penance, and meditation of lakhs of lifetimes open the window to come here. Even the gods and goddesses yearn to come here. *Darshan* and *ishnan* (bathing) here lead a person towards liberation. Liberation is the highest earning of all lifetimes. Every person, especially a Sikh, should pray that the Guru Sahib blesses them with the *darshan* and *ishnan* of Sri Harmandir Sahib Ji. Only when the Guru Sahib accepts the love and supplication does he grant *darshan*, and the filth of lifetimes is washed away. When your *karma* (destiny) opens, come with great devotion. If you are going by car, definitely take other members of the *sangat* (congregation) with you so that they too can have *darshan*. If you are going by bus, still take one or two members (of the *sangat*) with you. If possible, pay for the expenses and service on the way from your own pocket. On the way, keep listening only to devotion, praise, stories, and Kirtan related to the Guru Sahib. If you must go alone, keep your mind and consciousness connected to the Guru Sahib's feet. Do not say or listen to bad thoughts, useless talk, obscene jokes... etc. As soon as you reach Sri Darbar Sahib, complete all the rules with respect. Let there be no lack of devotion; perform every type of service, listen to Kirtan, maintain cleanliness, bathe... do everything

under all circumstances. If possible, definitely be present at the *Amrit Vela* (early morning) at the time of *Prakash* (enshrinement). Have *Prashad* offered, offer appropriate *maya* (money), and make an Ardas. Then, pray for *darshan*, perform *Parkarma* (circumambulation), and definitely go inside Sri Harmandir Sahib. Thank the Guru Sahib for the *darshan* and pray for peace in the world. Bring back *Prashad* and also the holy water - distribute it to the *sangat* and family. The Guru Sahib will bestow grace, and your life will be reformed.

Pages 80 and 85 are missing!

81. Preaching

Great works related to preaching are done by the S.G.P.C. Wherever there is a need and whenever time is available, the committee outlines programs related to preaching. The S.G.P.C.'s *Raagis* (hymn-singers), *Katha Vachaks* (discourse-givers), *Dhadis* (bards)..... are very supreme scholars (Gyanis). Only qualified preachers get an opportunity here. Preachers are also sent from here to other Gurdwaras. Their preachers preach as a qualified and salaried service. The *Raagi* from here, Bhai Sahib Bhai Nirmal Singh Khalsa, received the Padma Shri Award from the President. The method of preaching by the preachers here is of a very high caliber, and the committee is worthy of thanks for this work. In the time to come, it will become even more vibrant.

From the Gurdwara Act 1925-

The Punjab government, according to the Gurdwara Act 1925, conducted the very first election of the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee on July 18, 1926. The committee was formed with 120 members from Punjab, 16 members from the Sikh princely states of Punjab, and 14 from other provinces. In this, the Jathedar Sahibs of the 4 Takhts and one Head Granthi Sahib of Sri Harmandir Sahib were also considered included. The total number of members was 155. Even today, the leadership of the Gurdwara Act is acknowledged. From time to time, discussions and amended actions regarding the reform of the *Panth* (Sikh nation) and the Gurdwaras continue to take place.

The Very First Gurdwara Sahib-

...but according to information, the first place of the Guru Sahib was built at Sri Kartar Sahib. Here, Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji spent his final days farming and gave the sermon of *Kirat Karn* (earning an honest livelihood). It was here that the congregation's arrival increased, and the Guru Sahib merged with the Divine Light (passed away). This place of the Guru Sahib, who was respected as the Guru of the Sikhs and the Pir of the Muslims, is perhaps one of the special places in the world today. Where Pakistan's... Imran Khan spent billions of rupees to improve this place and opened the corridor (Langa). And in this, Navjot Singh Sidhu and the Modi government of Hindustan have a big role. The prayers of Jathedar S. Kuldip Singh Wadala for opening the corridor were accepted.

82. The Property of Sri Darbar Sahib

There is vast property in the name of Sri Darbar Sahib, which, over time, was (given by) King Akbar, (or) purchased by the Sri Guru Sahibs themselves to run the service and religious affairs. After this, devotees, and then wealthy devotees and kings of the time, and Maharaja Ranjit Singh had (land) endowed. In Pakistan, the Guru Sahib's (Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji's) Sikh devotee, Sri Rai Bular Ji, registered 18,500 acres in the Guru Sahib's name, which is still in the Guru's name today. The rest, in the name of Sri Darbar Sahib, there is land and much other property, from which a lot of income is generated. Where there is so much income, the expenses are also great. The management of all this property is with the SGPC.

Philanthropy by Sri Darbar Sahib-

Around 2020, Sri Darbar's budget is about 12-13 *Arab* (1.2-1.3 billion). This sum is spent on large projects here. Here, financial service is performed by devotees in various ways, and there is also an income of *crores* (tens of millions) from the property in Darbar Sahib's name, and from this, the expenses here are met. The rest, according to the orders of the Guru Sahibs, many philanthropic and preaching activities like our hospitals, educational institutions, organizations, preaching work, help during disasters..... etc., are always ongoing, on which billions of rupees are spent

and generated as income. Auspicious works are always ongoing. These works are made public.

Accounts-

There is an income and expenditure of 12-13 *Arab* (1.2-1.3 billion) here. All accounts here are kept on record and are published annually. Many works are also published on the web. The accounts, from the oldest to the newest, can be found. For this work, "Loha Yog" (highly capable/suitable) educated employees are kept, who manage the entire system in a very proper manner and maintain the accounts and management in an appropriate way. Just as the accounts of Sri Darbar Sahib are kept, it is also the rule to keep the accounts of all Gurdwaras under the SGPC here. This is a very big task - the Guru's grace continues.

83. Large Books are Not Beneficial

While writing the book on Sri Harmandir Sahib, I did a lot of research through 5-10 ancient books and other sources. I thank all the authors and books, from where I try to write well by researching something or other. Every author needs to take some knowledge from somewhere; it is the Guru Sahib's grace, and then a good book is written - the knowledge of history comes from books. I read a book of more than 520 pages, I will not write the name - some are around one or two hundred, some books are even larger. I ask for forgiveness - about these books, I make only one request: it is very difficult to read a 520-page book. And

in that book, 121 pages are written about the Granthi Singhs of Sri Darbar Sahib, and 70 pages are written about the Gyanis and Rababis. A lot can be written about the Granthi Singhs in two pages. Okay, let's say five. And Granthi, Gyani, Rababi are almost of the same sentiment... total "Panch" (five?) pages are enough. Forgive me, writing a total of 193 pages on Granthis, Gyanis, and Rababis is not necessary. If you say anything against such authors, it is "small mouth, big talk" (speaking out of turn). But this is also an injustice: 8-10 pages about Darbar Sahib and 193 pages for the Granthis. You can write well about Sri Darbar in a 100-page book, but don't write more than 150-200 pages. Choose some topics about which you can write more. The one who has influence in the SGPC honors the 500-600 page book mentioned above, but if someone like me, an author of 150 books by 2024, presents a good book in 100-150 pages, countless people will stand up to find faults, "color" (censure) it, and call it sacrilege. Well, there is politics in everything, and in any field, the one sitting on the 'Kursi' (seat of power) does not let even a more qualified person come near. I don't care about that, but I think one should not write useless (fluff) in books; write only the main essence. Every single word of authors like Jaswant Singh Kanwal, Buta Singh Shad, Jaggi Kushal UK... is perfectly set in its place - they do not write, and have not written, a single extra letter. I have chosen the topics for my book after research and have adopted the method of selecting the

maximum number of topics related to its scope and writing appropriate pages - I found this to be quite good, and with this, the topic remains focused. ... books are thousands of pages long – their price also increases - no one can read them, nor can they buy them. One book has become world-famous, I won't write the name, and the author became a 'crore-pati' (multi-millionaire), but in it, Hindus, their works, and traditions are heavily criticized, but not even 1% of a solution to the issue is written. Whoever's 'kite is flying' (is successful), he is the winner. All articles are worthy of thanks, but do not write books of 500-700-1000-2000 pages. A normal book of 100 pages is enough, the limit is 200-250, and in a minimum of 40-50 pages, you can publish a lot. If anyone's heart is hurt, please forgive me, but authors should reflect on my views.

84. Today's Situation

At Sri Darbar Sahib, established (manifested) for centuries, truth has always been victorious; the sentiments of the congregation have always been gracious. Today, the situation is one of high spirits (Chardi Kala), and every day, lakhs of devotees come for *darshan* from within the country and abroad. Day by day, its importance is gaining glory in the world - the congregation is becoming overjoyed.

Sri Amritsar Sahib was first known by the names Chak Guru, Guru Ka Chak, Chak Ramdas, Ramdas Pura, but finally became famous as Sri Amritsar Sahib. The

city, started with the inspiration of Sri Guru Amar Das Ji, and in 1577, the excavation of the Sarovar Sahib was initiated. The work begun by the father Guru was made permanent (Pakka) by Sri Guru Arjan Dev Ji in 1588 AD. On August 16, 1604, he had the Sri Adi Granth enshrined for the first time and gave Baba Buddha Ji the position of the first Granthi Sahib. The meaning of the place being built lower than the ground is that a person should come with humility to have their wishes fulfilled. The meaning of the four doors is the four *varnas* (classes), meaning anyone from all four directions may come; the doors are open for all.

Sri Darbar Sahib is 440 km from Delhi, 48 from Lahore, 80 from Jalandhar, 38 from Batala, 24 from Tarn Taran, 6500 from London, 11500 from New York, 6000 from Amsterdam, 5800 from Frankfurt, 6200 from Paris, 10590 from Melbourne, 6000 km from Tokyo, etc. kilometers away. From foreign countries, there are direct flights to Sri Amritsar, or via Delhi, Bombay. From the rest of India, it is possible to come by plane, train, bus, or one's own car.

Today, the entire city is very beautiful, especially near Darbar Sahib. Every effort is made to maintain the beauty, and the surroundings have been made quite beautiful and open. The management here is in the hands of the S.G.P.C., and the annual income is 500 Crore (5 billion), and the committee is running auspicious works, projects of high spirits, and institutions. Every devotee who comes is welcomed,

but it is mandatory to keep the rules in mind. The management committee works very hard, and every effort is made for success in handling the large-scale arrangements. In the name of Sri Darbar Sahib... acres of land. There are other properties as well, which were endowed as service by kings, Sardars, philanthropists, and warriors of the time. The annual... offering is... and the expenses are also large. The political party here is SAD (Shiromani Akali Dal), which is active in politics. Thousands of other institutions are also connected with Sri Darbar Sahib. To fight against oppression with devotion and power is in the blood of the Sikhs. Internal battles also keep happening among them. It is necessary to stop causing one's own loss through these. Today's situation of Sri Amritsar Sahib and Darbar Sahib is by the Guru's grace. Every devotee is welcomed - the Guru Sahib honors the sentiment of devotion.

86. A Request for Forgiveness from the Author

O Holy Congregation, No one can give a (full) description of God and God's home. It is by the Guru's grace, and when He inspires, that someone does some preaching, expansion, (writes) a book, or (gives) a discourse in His praise. Whatever it is, to this day, no one has been able to give a complete definition. In this task, by the Guru's grace, preaching and books are found in the world. Grace was bestowed upon this

humble servant, and the Guru blessed me with the opportunity for the service of preaching and (writing) books. It was my heartfelt wish and also my prayer that the Guru Sahib bless me with the strength to perform service. By grace, He has had this work completed and has shown me great mercy. He has blessed my extensive research and hard work with fruit, which is before you.

It is very difficult to write on this subject, but by the Guru's grace, obstacles are removed. The rest, the request is that when an author dedicates his days and nights and devotes his breaths to the Guru's work, the congregation and organizations should kindly support and encourage him. This does happen many times, but sometimes people pester the author by catching mistakes in words or in the essence. A request to such people: please do not do this. Please be kind, encourage the author. Value his writings and give him more opportunities to adorn them, because books are a moving school (Pathshala). A nation that values its schools is a knowledgeable one. The rest is all one's own thinking. Today's time is such that *Amrit* (nectar) is considered bitter and *Vikh* (poison) is consumed as if it is sweet.

Anyway! My prayer is that if something in the book is not to your liking or if there is a new conclusion, his 'head should not be broken' - please respect the *Dastar*

(turban) placed on his head. For this reason, I request you to respect the book and give a place in your heart to the solid praise of Sri Darbar Sahib. Every human makes mistakes and errors. If you see something like that, do not create a controversy. I hope that every author's service is cared for and respected. Honor good books as well. I already pray for forgiveness for my flaws, mistakes, and shortcomings!

S. Davinder Singh Thamanwal, Holland.

Books and Films written by this humble servant

[Books] Kirt Karam Ke Vichhude, Satgur Nanak Pargateya, Guru Tegh Bahadur Simriye, Aisi Lal Tujh Bin Kaun Karai, Vaho Vaho Guru Gobind Singh Ji, Guru Nanak Gurdwara Amsterdam, Sat Bhakhai Ravidas, Punjabi Duniya, Mittar Piare Nu, Beadbian Kiven Rukan, Sri Harmandir Sahib, Mukti Ki, Kiven Ate Kyun, Langar Ki, Kiven Ate Kyun, 550 Sala Gurpurab, Dalit Tarakki Kiven Karan, Jankari Sri Guru Granth Sahib Ji, Tera Kia Meetha Lagai, Chhotian Jindan Vadde Saake, Kurbanian Kalgian Wale Dian, Shaheed Bhai Mani Singh Ji, Sikh Kaum Tarakki Kiven Kare, Sikh Kaum De Bawal, Saka Chamkaur Sahib, Parupkari Bhai Ghannaiya Ji, Mahaan Jarnail Baba Banda Singh Ji Bahadur, Sarbatt Itihas Gurdware, Mahaan Bibian, Sri Darbar Sahib 'Te Hamle, Ik Committee Da Sanvidhan, Prasidh Nagar Kirtan Ate Prabhat Pheri, Bhai Harpal Ate Satguru Sri Guru Hargobind Sahib Ji, Bhai Manjh Ji, Sikh Di Laaj Rakhni, Sri Kishan Bhagwan Arjun Ate Lakkarhara, Bhai Sujan Singh Ji, Bhai Saida Malah, Bhai Balaki Das Ji, Bhai Phaggu Ji

[Films written by this humble servant] Nahin Jaana Pardes, Chori Di Roti, Dhrig Aisa Pyaar, Maa Jiha Rabb Na Koi, Mera Mobile Kharab Hai, Face Book, Bapu Videsh Vich, Film NRI, Paras Pooja, Heer Ranjha, Rang

Prem Da, Jatt Bhagat Dhanna Ji, Aisa Chahoon Raaj Main, Maa Di Kasam, Parali Nu Kutta Billi Utte Maas Jammna, Kahanian Dian Pustakan, Daaron Vichhri Koonj, Kandhe Utte Mehrma Ve, Koi Nahin Kise Da Beli, Charde Suraj Nu Salaam, Aisa Hai Pardes, Main Jaana Dukh Mujh Ko, Att Khuda Da Vair

[Other books] Hadse Kiven Rukan, Khedan Vich Tarakki Kiven Hove, CM Charanjit Singh Channi, CM Bhagwant Singh Maan – ongoing, Deep Sidhu Ik Mahaan Soch, Kisan Andolan - Eh Kabaddi Kitab, Beadbian Kiven Rukan, Desh Tarakki Kiven Kare, Balatkar Kiven Rukan, Randhawa Pind Mahalan, Fatehveer Singh Borwell Vich Diggia 4 Sala Bachha, Mere Geet, Meri Kahani Mere Geet Rahin, Maut De Chehre, Awara Pashu Kutte Ate Jantaan Da Hall, Swachh Bharat - Special, maybe the PM will release it, Kisana Dian Khudkushian Rukan, Punjabian Dian Akhanan Ate Muhavare, General Knowledge, Gurmeet Ram Rahim, Sarkari Khazana Kiven Bhare, Shabad-Shukar-Sarmatt Fakir Ate Aurangzeb

+50 more books

[Special books] Rangla Punjab, Nasha Mukt Punjab Kiven Hove, Balatkar Kiven Rukan, Hadse Kiven Rukkan, Kisan Khudkushian Kiven, Turi Parali Masla, Harhan Ton Kiven Bachian Jaave, Beadbian Kiven Rukan, Khedan Tarakki Kiven Karn..... Ajj De Masand.

Note: You will get the website for the books soon - just a little more wait. Thank you. More books regarding the pains of Punjab are started, which are very beneficial/welfare-oriented for Punjab or the world.

We have not paid much attention to people learning about Sikhs and respecting a great religion. While living abroad, I feel this is necessary. Being a Sikh, sometimes people feel strange seeing the turban, but we need to do the work of [spreading] the Sikh identity, and Sri Darbar Sahib is considered a Sikh Temple - Because of this issue, I have written this book, 'I have seen all the places, but none like you,' and an attempt will be made to publish it in various foreign languages. There are many expenses for this, about which I will appeal to the congregation for help on the internet and media. If help is received, this work can be successful; otherwise, I can definitely put the PDF in Punjabi, Hindi, English, and some other languages on the net. The rest, may the readers understand my sentiment - this book is very necessary - the congregation is great - it will complete the Guru's work.

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